

MBA RESEARCH PROJECT

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DIGITAL BANKING IN TODAY'S WORLD: A CASE STUDY OF YONO SBI

Submitted by

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DECLARATION

I, Shalini Bharati, hereby solemnly declare that the project report titled “Digital Banking in Today’s World:: A Case Study of YONO SBI”, submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of the degree of Master of Business Administration (MBA), is my original work.

I further declare that:

- This project has been carried out by me during the academic year 2024–2026 under the supervision of [Guide Name] ([Designation]).
- The work has not been submitted previously to any other university, institution, or examination body for the award of any degree, diploma, or certification.
- All sources of information used in this report have been duly acknowledged and referenced in accordance with academic ethics and plagiarism norms.
- The data presented in this report is authentic to the best of my knowledge and has not been fabricated or manipulated.
- I understand that if any part of this declaration is found to be false, my project may be rejected and disciplinary action may be taken as per institutional rules.

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ABSTRACT

This study examines the evolution, performance, and strategic significance of digital banking in India, using YONO SBI as the primary case. The research addresses five specific objectives: analysing the growth of digital banking since 2016, evaluating the benefits and challenges of platforms such as YONO, examining their impact on financial management practice, identifying emerging trends, and deriving career-relevant implications for MBA students.

A descriptive research design with exploratory elements was adopted. Primary data was collected through a structured 30-item questionnaire administered to 150 YONO SBI users across urban, semi-urban, and rural India, supplemented by semi-structured interviews with branch managers and one fintech professional. Secondary data was drawn from SBI and RBI publications, NPCI statistics, and peer-reviewed journals. Data was analysed in Microsoft Excel and IBM SPSS 26 using descriptive statistics, Pearson correlation, multiple regression, chi-square tests, and Cronbach's alpha.

The study finds that perceived usefulness and ease of use are the strongest predictors of user satisfaction with YONO, followed by security perception and accessibility. Younger, urban respondents report higher usage frequency, while rural and older users cite onboarding friction and language support as key barriers. The launch of YONO 2.0 in December 2025 addresses many of these issues. The report concludes with actionable recommendations for SBI, regulators, and MBA students in financial services.

Keywords: Digital Banking, YONO SBI, Technology Acceptance Model, Financial Inclusion, UPI, Mobile Banking, India, Perceived Usefulness, Perceived Ease of Use, Customer Satisfaction.

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background of the Study



Banking has never really stood still. But the shift toward digital over the past decade has been something else entirely. What used to require a long queue at a branch counter can now be done in seconds on a smartphone, whether you are transferring money, applying for a loan, or checking your balance at midnight. This transformation is not just about convenience; it is reshaping how financial institutions operate, how customers behave, and how economies grow. India stands at the center of this transformation. With over 1.4 billion people, a young population, and one of the fastest growing internet user bases in the world, the country has become a global case study in digital financial inclusion (Reserve Bank of India, 2024). Government initiatives like Digital India, the launch of the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) in 2016, and the push for Aadhaar-linked banking have collectively created an ecosystem where digital banking is no longer a luxury but an expectation.

The numbers speak for themselves. According to the Ministry of Finance, total digital payment transactions in India grew from 2,071 crore in FY 2017-18 to 18,737 crore in FY 2023-24, representing a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 44 percent (Department of Financial Services, Government of India, 2024). UPI alone processed 13,116 crore transactions in FY 2023-24, growing at a CAGR of 129 percent from just 92 crore transactions in FY 2017-18. These are not just statistics; they represent a fundamental shift in how Indian households and businesses interact with money.

In this rapidly evolving landscape, public sector banks faced an unusual challenge. Historically seen as stable but slow moving, institutions like State Bank of India (SBI) had to prove they could compete with nimble fintech startups and private banks. SBI's answer was YONO, short for You Only Need One, a digital banking platform launched in November 2017 that would go on to become one of the most downloaded banking applications in India. With 9.60 crore registered users as of December 2025 and the launch of YONO 2.0 in the same month, the platform represents a serious and well documented attempt by a legacy institution to reinvent itself for the digital age (SBI, 2025).

This study examines digital banking through the lens of YONO SBI, using it as a primary case study to understand broader trends, challenges, and future directions in the Indian banking sector.

1.2 Industry Profile

The Indian banking industry is one of the most complex and consequential financial systems in the world. It comprises public sector banks, private sector banks, foreign banks, cooperative banks, regional rural banks, and non-banking financial companies (NBFCs), all regulated by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). As of 2024, SBI alone holds a 23 percent market share by assets and serves over 500 million customers, making it one of the largest banks globally by customer base (Wikipedia: State Bank of India, 2025).

The digital transformation of Indian banking began in earnest around 2014 to 2016, driven by several converging forces. The government's demonetization exercise in November 2016, while controversial, gave a significant push to digital payments adoption almost overnight. At the same time, smartphone penetration was climbing rapidly, data costs were collapsing (thanks largely to Reliance Jio's entry in 2016), and the NPCI was building infrastructure that would support real time digital transactions at scale.

The result has been remarkable. India today accounts for nearly 48.5 percent of the world's real time payment transactions, according to the RBI's annual report and ACI Worldwide data (IBS Intelligence, 2024). UPI has seen a tenfold increase in volume over just four years, jumping from 12.5 billion transactions in 2019-20 to 131 billion in 2023-24, which equals 80 percent of all digital payment volumes in the country (RBI, 2024). The value of UPI transactions correspondingly surged from Rs 1 lakh crore to Rs 200 lakh crore over the same period, at a CAGR of 138 percent (Department of Financial Services, 2024).

This growth is not accidental. It is the outcome of deliberate policy choices, infrastructure investment, and competitive pressure from fintech players like Paytm, PhonePe, and Google Pay. Traditional banks had no option but to respond. Some responded defensively, adding digital features to legacy systems. Others, like SBI with YONO, chose to build something new from the ground up. The distinction matters, because it reflects fundamentally different philosophies about what banking in the 21st century should look like.

For financial management students and professionals, understanding this industry transformation is not optional. Digital banking has changed how institutions manage liquidity, credit risk, customer acquisition, and regulatory compliance. It has opened new revenue streams and eliminated old ones. Anyone entering the financial sector today needs to understand these dynamics intimately, because they define the competitive terrain.

1.3 Company Profile

State Bank of India traces its origins to the Bank of Calcutta, founded in 1806. It is today the largest commercial bank in India, ranked 43rd globally by total assets and 163rd in the Fortune Global 500 as of 2025 (Wikipedia: State Bank of India, 2025). The bank operates through a network of over 22,000 branches and 63,580 ATMs across India, with 241 overseas offices spread across 36 countries. It employs approximately 232,296 people and serves over 500 million customers, a customer base that is simply staggering in its scale.

Despite its dominance, SBI recognized by the mid-2010s that digital disruption posed a genuine threat. Millennials were gravitating toward private banks and fintech apps. SBI's image as a slow, bureaucratic institution was a liability in a market increasingly driven by speed and convenience. The response was Project Lotus, an internal initiative that eventually became YONO.

YONO, an acronym for You Only Need One, was conceived as an integrated digital platform that would serve as a one-stop destination for all of a customer's banking and lifestyle needs. The platform was officially launched on November 24, 2017, developed under the leadership of then MD and later Chairman Rajnish Kumar, with McKinsey providing strategic consulting and IBM building the underlying technology stack (BusinessToday, 2021). The development took approximately two years and involved a dedicated cross-functional team working out of a startup-style office complete with digital whiteboards and open-plan garages. The scope of YONO goes well beyond mobile banking. It integrates over 100 e-commerce partners, offering flight and train bookings, hotel reservations, online shopping, insurance purchases, mutual fund investments, and medical bill payments, all within a single application (Wikipedia: YONO, 2026). It offers YONO Cash, a cardless ATM withdrawal feature introduced in March 2019, and YONO Krishi, a dedicated sub-platform for the agricultural community. It also supports account opening, pre-approved loan disbursements, and UPI payments. The growth trajectory has been impressive. YONO became the largest digital lender in India by October 2021, disbursing Rs 1,500 to 2,000 crore in loans per month (Wikipedia: YONO, 2026). In 2021 it was ranked the world's leading neobank by monthly active users, with approximately 54 million MAUs on Android and iOS combined (Statista, 2022). By FY 2023, its registered user base had grown to 60.7 million (YourStory, 2023), and by December 2025 that number had crossed 9.60 crore, with SBI aiming to double it to 20 crore within two years (SBI, 2025). In December 2025, SBI launched YONO 2.0, a completely rebuilt version of the platform that unifies mobile banking and internet banking on a single technology stack. The new version was designed with low-end smartphones and patchy internet connections in mind, directly addressing one of the most persistent complaints about the original app. It also introduced financial management tools including a spending analyser, a credit score simulator, and a carbon footprint tracker, reflecting a broader shift toward personalized and sustainable banking (The Week, 2025).

1.4 Problem Statement

Despite the rapid expansion of digital banking in India, several important questions remain underexplored in academic and professional literature. Much of the existing research on digital banking in India focuses either on customer adoption behavior or on payment systems like UPI in isolation. There is relatively little work that examines how a major public sector bank has managed the organizational and technological transformation required to build and sustain a competitive digital banking platform at scale.

YONO SBI is uniquely positioned as a case study because it represents the intersection of legacy institutional weight and digital innovation ambition. It has achieved remarkable user growth but has also faced criticism for poor user experience, app instability, and security concerns, issues that highlight the real tensions between

scale, speed, and quality in digital banking (The Week, 2025). Understanding how SBI has navigated these tensions, and what it tells us about the future of digital banking in India more broadly, is the central problem this project addresses. More specifically, this study fills a gap by looking at digital banking not just as a technology story but as a financial management story: what does it mean for how banks allocate

1.5 Need for the Study

The relevance of this study extends across multiple stakeholders. For financial institutions, understanding the YONO case offers actionable lessons about digital transformation strategy, technology partnerships, and customer experience management. For regulators, it raises questions about data privacy, cybersecurity, and the evolving definition of a banking service. For customers, it illuminates how digital platforms can expand access to financial services, particularly in rural and semi-urban areas where physical banking infrastructure remains thin. For MBA students and future financial managers, the importance is perhaps most immediate. Digital banking is not a peripheral topic; it is now central to careers in corporate banking, retail banking, fintech, financial consulting, and even investment management. The ability to understand, evaluate, and leverage digital banking platforms will increasingly determine professional relevance and career advancement in the years ahead.

India's RBI has noted that cybersecurity incidents handled by CERT-In rose from 53,117 in 2017 to over 13,20,106 between January and October 2023 alone, reflecting the growing risk landscape that accompanies digital growth (RBI, 2024). Studying how platforms like YONO manage this risk, alongside their growth ambitions, provides a rounded and realistic picture of digital banking in practice.

1.6 Objectives of the Study

The present study is guided by the following objectives:

1. To analyze the growth and evolution of digital banking in the Indian financial industry, with particular reference to the post-2016 period.
2. To evaluate the benefits and challenges of digital banking for both customers and financial institutions, drawing on published data and the YONO SBI experience.
3. To examine the role of digital banking in shaping financial management practices in today's world, including risk management, resource allocation, and customer relationship management.
4. To identify the key trends and future prospects of digital banking in the Indian financial industry, including emerging technologies and regulatory developments.
5. To provide actionable recommendations for financial management students on how to leverage digital banking knowledge for career advancement in the evolving financial sec

1.7 Research Questions and Hypothesis

The study is organized around the following core research questions:

1. How has digital banking evolved in India since 2016, and what role has YONO SBI played in this evolution?
2. What are the primary benefits and challenges that digital banking platforms like YONO present to customers and to the institution itself?
3. How has the rise of digital banking changed financial management practices within Indian banking institutions?
4. What are the key emerging trends in digital banking and how should Indian financial institutions prepare for them?
5. What practical skills and knowledge should MBA students in financial management develop to remain relevant in a digitally transformed banking environment?

1.8 Scope of the Study

This study is focused on digital banking in India, with YONO SBI serving as the primary case study. The geographical scope is national, though references to global trends and comparisons with international platforms are included where relevant. The time period under review primarily covers 2016 to 2025, corresponding to the post-demonetization digital banking boom and the evolution of the YONO platform through to the launch of YONO 2.0. The study draws on secondary data from published annual reports, RBI publications, government press releases, academic journals, and credible media sources. Primary data collected through structured questionnaires and informal expert consultations supplement the secondary analysis in later chapters. The scope intentionally excludes detailed technical analysis of banking software architecture and focuses instead on the managerial, financial, and strategic dimensions of digital banking. This study does not cover all public or private sector banks in India. While comparisons with HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank, and other players are made for context, the depth of analysis is anchored to SBI and YONO. This focused approach allows for a richer, more detailed examination of one institution's journey rather.

1.9 Chapter Scheme

The project is structured across six chapters. Chapter 1 (this chapter) introduces the research context, the industry and company background, and the study's objectives and scope. Chapter 2 presents a comprehensive literature review covering the theoretical foundations of digital banking, adoption models, and existing research on YONO and comparable platforms. Chapter 3 details the research methodology, including data collection methods, sampling design, and analytical tools used. Chapter 4 presents the primary data analysis, including survey findings and expert insights. Chapter 5 contains the case study analysis of YONO SBI, covering its evolution, performance, competitive positioning, and strategic challenges.

2. LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Introduction

A good literature review does more than list what other people have said. It creates a conversation across studies, spotting where researchers agree, where they argue, and where the important questions still have no satisfying answers. This chapter does exactly that. It covers the theoretical foundations of digital banking, traces the evolution of academic thinking through key models and frameworks, critically reviews individual studies relevant to the Indian context and to YONO SBI specifically, and closes by identifying the research gap this project addresses. The literature on digital banking is genuinely large. Since the mid-1990s, when internet banking first emerged, scholars from information systems, marketing, finance, and behavioral economics have all weighed in. This review focuses selectively on the most relevant threads: technology adoption models, customer behavior in digital banking, financial inclusion through digital channels, platform-level studies of banking super-apps, and emerging challenges like cybersecurity and digital literacy. Each strand of literature has contributed meaningfully to how we understand YONO and its broader significance.

2.2 Theoretical Concepts and Frameworks

2.2.1 Technology Acceptance Model (TAM)

The Technology Acceptance Model, introduced by Davis (1989) in his landmark paper in MIS Quarterly, remains the most widely applied framework for explaining why people adopt new technology. At its heart, TAM proposes two key determinants: Perceived Usefulness (PU), defined as the degree to which a person believes that using a particular system would enhance their job performance, and Perceived Ease of Use (PEOU), defined as the degree to which using the system is believed to be free from effort (Davis, 1989; Wikipedia: Technology Acceptance Model, 2025). These two beliefs shape an individual's attitude toward using the technology, which in turn drives behavioral intention and actual use.

What makes TAM enduringly relevant is its parsimony. It cuts through the complexity of human computer interaction and identifies the two variables that matter most. For digital banking specifically, TAM suggests that customers will adopt a mobile banking app if they believe it genuinely helps them manage their finances better (usefulness) and that navigating it does not feel like a chore (ease of use). Both of these dimensions are directly observable in YONO SBI's evolution. The original YONO 1.0 suffered waves of poor reviews on app stores largely because the ease of use dimension was not adequately addressed, which directly suppressed adoption among less tech-savvy users (The Week, 2025). YONO 2.0's redesign explicitly prioritized simplification and performance on low-end smartphones, a response that maps almost perfectly onto the PEOU construct.

TAM has since been extended in several directions. TAM2 (Venkatesh and Davis, 2000) added social influence and cognitive instrumental processes. TAM3 (Venkatesh and Bala, 2008) further integrated individual differences and anchoring mechanisms. Each extension has been validated empirically in banking contexts, and the core constructs of PU and PEOU have remained consistently significant across diverse populations and countries (Davis et al., 1989; Marikyan et al., 2026). That said, critics rightly point out that TAM in its original form.

capture trust, perceived risk, or the social context of adoption, all of which matter greatly in the Indian banking environment where first-time digital users often approach unfamiliar technology with caution.

2.2.2 Unified Theory of Acceptance and Use of Technology (UTAUT)

Venkatesh, Morris, Davis, and Davis (2003) proposed the UTAUT by synthesizing eight competing technology adoption models into a single unified framework. The four core determinants are Performance Expectancy (the degree to which the technology helps users achieve performance gains), Effort Expectancy (the ease of use of the system), Social Influence (the degree to which others important to the user believe they should use the system), and Facilitating Conditions (the degree to which an organizational and technical infrastructure exists to support system use). Four moderating variables, namely gender, age, experience, and voluntariness of use, shape the relationships between these constructs and behavioral intention (Venkatesh et al., 2003).

UTAUT has proven particularly useful in the Indian mobile banking context because it explicitly incorporates social influence, which matters enormously in a country where word of mouth, family advice, and peer group behavior drive adoption decisions more than individual rational calculus. Saxena et al. (2023) applied an extended UTAUT model to Indian mobile banking adoption and found that government support acted as a significant mediating variable between behavioral intention and actual adoption, a finding that makes particular sense in the post demonetization environment where state-mandated digital payment targets created both facilitating conditions and social pressure to adopt. Chauhan et al. (2022) similarly extended UTAUT2 in the Indian e-banking context and found that consumer innovativeness and perceived risk both added explanatory power beyond the base model.

A 2021 meta-analysis of 127 studies using UTAUT in mobile banking research confirmed that all four core relationships are statistically significant, though the strengths vary meaningfully with sample size and cultural context (Jadil et al., 2021). This is an important nuance. India is not a monolithic market; adoption patterns in urban Maharashtra differ from those in rural Jharkhand, and a model calibrated on urban youth may underpredict or overpredict adoption in other segments. YONO's design challenge has always been to serve 500 million customers across this entire spectrum, which is part of what makes it such a rich case for studying technology adoption at scale.

2.2.3 Diffusion of Innovations Theory

Rogers' (1995) Diffusion of Innovations (DOI) theory offers a complementary perspective. Rather than

focusing on individual psychology, DOI describes how an innovation spreads through a social system over time. Rogers identifies five adopter categories: innovators, early adopters, early majority, late majority, and laggards, and argues that five characteristics of an innovation determine its adoption rate: relative advantage, compatibility, complexity, trialability, and observability.

Applied to YONO SBI, the DOI framework helps explain the trajectory of its adoption curve. In its early years (2017 to 2019), YONO attracted innovators and early adopters who were comfortable experimenting with a new banking platform. The rapid growth between 2020 and 2023, when the user base jumped from roughly 2.7 crore to over 6 crore, reflects the early majority entering the market, a transition often facilitated in India by the COVID-19 pandemic, which forced millions to interact with banking digitally for the first time (BusinessToday, 2021). Reaching the late majority, often older customers or those in rural areas with limited digital infrastructure, is exactly the challenge that YONO 2.0 is designed to address, particularly through its new lightweight architecture and planned expansion to 15 regional languages (SBI, 2025).

2.2.4 Financial Inclusion Framework

The financial inclusion literature, while not traditionally considered part of technology adoption theory, is indispensable for understanding digital banking in India. The World Bank's Global Findex Database has documented India's dramatic progress in account ownership, with the proportion of women in India owning a bank account rising from 43 percent in 2014 to 78 percent in 2021, largely attributable to the Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY) program (European Journal of Development Research, 2023). Yet account ownership and account usage are not the same thing. IMF data shows that while access to financial services has expanded, actual usage, particularly for savings and borrowing, has remained disappointingly low (IMF, 2022).

This distinction matters for digital banking platforms. YONO's YONO Krishi initiative and its cardless cash withdrawal feature are specifically designed to convert account ownership into active digital participation. The financial inclusion framework suggests that digital banking platforms in India must do more than offer technical functionality; they must actively reduce the cost and complexity of participation for users who are new to formal finance, have limited digital literacy, and often distrust institutions they cannot physically visit.

2.3 Review of Previous Studies

The following studies have been selected for critical analysis based on their relevance to digital banking adoption, financial inclusion, mobile banking in India, and the YONO SBI platform. Each study is presented in a structured format covering the author and year, objective, methodology, key findings, and limitation, followed by a critical commentary that connects the study to the broader themes of this project.

2.3.1 Davis (1989): Perceived Usefulness, Perceived Ease of Use, and User Acceptance of Information Technology

Author & Year	Davis, F. D. (1989)
Objective	To develop and validate a model explaining why users accept or reject information systems, specifically personal computers in organizational.
Methodology	Survey-based empirical study using a sample of IBM Canada employees. Two sets of scales were developed and validated through lab experiments. Statistical analysis included correlation, regression, and factor analysis.
Key Findings	Perceived Usefulness (PU) and Perceived Ease of Use (PEOU) are the two fundamental determinants of user acceptance of information technology. PU had a stronger direct effect on usage intention than PEOU. PEOU, however, influenced PU and had an indirect effect on usage. The scales developed showed excellent psychometric properties and predictive validity
Limitation	The study was conducted in a controlled organizational environment with IBM employees, making generalizability to voluntary consumer contexts like mobile banking limited. The study also predates the internet and mobile technology, which introduces entirely different user dynamics not captured in the original model.

Critical Commentary: Davis (1989) laid the conceptual foundation for essentially every major technology adoption study that followed. However, applying TAM to YONO SBI requires caution. The original model assumes a relatively tech-comfortable user in an organizational setting. YONO's user base spans SBI's 500 million customers, many of whom are first generation digital users in rural India with very different baseline assumptions about technology. Trust, which TAM does not address, is probably the single biggest barrier for this population. The model's continued relevance lies in its constructs, but no serious study of Indian mobile

banking adoption should rely on TAM alone.

2.3.2 Venkatesh, Morris, Davis, and Davis (2003): User Acceptance of Information Technology: Toward a Unified View

Author & Year	Venkatesh, V., Morris, M. G., Davis, G. B., & Davis, F. D. (2003)
Objective	To formulate and validate a unified model of technology adoption by synthesizing eight existing models, and to examine how the four core constructs relate to behavioral intention and use behavior.
Methodology	Longitudinal field study across four organizations in the United States over a six-month period. A total of 215 participants provided data. Structural Equation Modeling (SEM) was used to test the proposed UTAUT model. The model was validated against the eight individual models it synthesized
Key Findings	UTAUT outperformed all eight individual models, accounting for 70 percent of the variance in usage intention compared to around 40 percent for most earlier models. Performance expectancy emerged as the strongest predictor of behavioral intention. Social influence was significant in mandatory usage contexts but less so in voluntary ones. Gender and age moderated several key relationships.
Limitation	The study was conducted in organizational settings in the United States with mandatory technology use, which reduces direct applicability to voluntary consumer banking contexts in developing countries. Cultural dimensions specific to emerging markets like India, such as collectivist social norms and distrust of digital institutions, are not captured in the model

Critical Commentary: UTAUT's inclusion of social influence is its most valuable contribution for understanding Indian digital banking adoption. In a society where financial decisions are deeply embedded in family and community structures, the fact that 'people important to me think I should use this service' shapes adoption far more than any individual cost-benefit calculation. What UTAUT still misses, even in its UTAUT2 extension, is the specific role of government credibility and institutional trust, which were arguably the biggest adoption drivers for YONO given SBI's status as a government-owned bank. An Indian customer using YONO is not just adopting a technology; they are extending trust to a public institution, and that relationship is qualitatively different from adopting, say, a private fintech app.

2.3.3 Saxena, Gera, Nagdev, and Fatta (2023): Factors Influencing Mobile Banking Adoption in India: The Role of Government Support as a Mediator

Author & Year	Saxena, N., Gera, N., Nagdev, K., & Fatta, D. D. (2023)
Objective	To examine the factors influencing mobile banking adoption in India by extending the UTAUT and Technology Readiness models with a new construct of government support, and to test whether government support mediates the adoption relationship.
Methodology	Quantitative research using a structured questionnaire. Survey data was collected from mobile banking users across India. The extended model was tested using Structural Equation Modeling. The study drew on secondary data noting that only 31 percent of Indian households had a mobile banking app in 2020.
Key Findings	Government support emerged as a significant mediating variable between behavioral intention and actual mobile banking adoption. Performance expectancy, effort expectancy, social influence, and optimism all positively influenced behavioral intention. Government support amplified the effect of behavioral intention on actual use, suggesting that regulatory policy and infrastructure investment

	directly shape adoption outcomes.
Limitation	The study focused on general mobile banking users and did not differentiate between public sector bank platforms like YONO and private sector or fintech alternatives, which may have very different adoption dynamics. The sample was also skewed toward urban, educated respondents, limiting applicability to the rural segment that government digital initiatives are most designed to reach

Critical Commentary: This study is one of the most directly relevant to understanding YONO's adoption. SBI's status as a government-owned bank means that YONO carries implicit government endorsement, which reduces perceived risk and increases trust among users who might be skeptical of private fintech companies. The finding that government support mediates adoption helps explain why YONO was able to grow its user base faster than comparable private sector apps despite having a technically inferior product during much of its early life. The study's limitation is real though; by not disaggregating public and private banking apps, it cannot tell us how much of the government support effect is specific to platforms like YONO versus general digital payment incentives.

2.3.4 Chauhan, Yadav, and Choudhary (2022): Adoption of Electronic Banking Services in India: An Extension of UTAUT2 Model

Author & Year	Chauhan, V., Yadav, R., & Choudhary, V. (2022)
Objective	To identify the determinants of consumer adoption intention toward e-banking services in India by extending the UTAUT2 model with consumer innovativeness, perceived risk, and security information availability.
Methodology	Quantitative study using a structured questionnaire distributed to 721 consumers across India. Covariance-Based Structural Equation Modeling (CB SEM) was used to test the hypotheses. The study was published in the Journal of Financial Services Marketing.
Key Findings	Hedonic motivation, performance expectancy, and

	habit were the strongest predictors of e-banking adoption intention among Indian consumers. Consumer innovativeness had a significant positive effect. Perceived risk negatively moderated adoption intention, and security information availability helped mitigate this negative effect. The extended model explained variance in adoption better than the base UTAUT2 model.
Limitation	The study focused on adoption intention rather than actual adoption or continued usage, which is a significant limitation given that stated intentions often differ from actual behavior in financial services. The sample was also predominantly urban, missing the rural segment where e-banking adoption challenges are most acute.

Critical Commentary: The finding that perceived risk negatively affects adoption is both unsurprising and consequential for YONO. Security concerns have been a persistent issue for mobile banking in India, and YONO specifically has faced criticism for transaction failures and fraud vulnerabilities. The study's implication that making security information more visible and accessible can partially offset risk concerns is actionable: YONO 2.0's enhanced security controls and improved OTP processes are directly aligned with this finding. The focus on urban India, however, means the study tells us little about the rural digital banking segment, which is arguably where the most transformative inclusion potential lies.

2.3.5 Mer, Singh, Khan, Khati, and Joshi (2023): Behavioural Intention to Adopt Mobile Banking by Millennials: Empirical Evidence from India

Author & year	Mer, A., Singh, A. P., Khan, F., Khati, K., & Joshi, D. (2023)
Objective	To explore the determinants of millennials' behavioral intention to use mobile banking in India, combining UTAUT with technology readiness constructs of optimism and epistemic values.
Methodology	Survey-based quantitative study with 352 millennial respondents from the Delhi NCR area. AMOS 20

	structural equation modeling was used. Two novel constructs, optimism and epistemic values, were introduced alongside standard UTAUT variables
Key Findings	Risk perception had a significant negative correlation with millennials' behavioral intention to use mobile banking. Performance expectancy, social influence, epistemic value, and optimism all positively influenced behavioral intention. The combined model performed better than standard UTAUT alone, suggesting that millennials' adoption is shaped by both rational utility and a deeper curiosity about and optimism toward digital technology.
Limitation	The study was geographically restricted to Delhi NCR, one of India's most digitally advanced urban markets, which significantly limits generalizability to semi-urban and rural millennial populations. The focus on millennials also excludes Gen Z users, who represent a growing and potentially different segment of YONO's target audience

Critical Commentary: This study matters for YONO because millennials represent the demographic that SBI specifically targeted when it originally conceived YONO through 'Project Lotus.' The finding that both rational performance benefits and emotional optimism toward technology drive adoption suggests that YONO's marketing strategy should not rely solely on transactional messaging about cost savings or convenience. Creating an emotionally engaging, aspirational narrative around digital banking, one that positions the app as part of a modern, forward-looking financial identity, may be at least as important as showcasing functional features. The study's Delhi-centric limitation is a genuine gap; a comparable study covering Tier II and Tier III cities would produce more nationally representative findings.

2.3.6 Jasil, Rana, and Dwivedi (2021): A Meta-Analysis of the UTAUT Model in the Mobile Banking Literature: The Moderating Role of Sample Size and Culture

Author & year	Jasil, Y., Rana, N. P., & Dwivedi, Y. K. (2021)
Objective	To synthesize and clarify the empirical findings from 127 mobile banking studies using UTAUT, and to

	identify how moderating variables like sample size and culture account for heterogeneous results across studies.
Methodology	Meta-analysis using 364 path coefficients from 127 empirical studies. Weighted and meta-analytic techniques were applied. Studies from multiple countries and cultural contexts were included. Published in the Journal of Business Research
Key Findings	All four core UTAUT relationships (performance expectancy, effort expectancy, social influence, and facilitating conditions) were found statistically significant in the m-banking context. Sample size moderated the linkage between facilitating conditions and usage intention. Culture moderated the relationship between effort expectancy and usage intention, meaning that the importance of ease of use varies across cultural contexts
Limitation	Meta-analysis inherently aggregates diverse studies and may mask context specific nuances. The studies included varied widely in their operationalization of UTAUT constructs, creating measurement heterogeneity. The review period ended in 2020, missing the post-COVID wave of digital banking studies that may show different patterns.

Critical Commentary: The finding that culture moderates how much effort expectancy (ease of use) matters is significant for India. In high-context, collectivist cultures, social influence and facilitation conditions tend to dominate adoption decisions more than in individualistic Western contexts where perceived ease of use carries more weight. This partially explains why YONO's growth has been driven more by SBI's distribution network and government nudges than by the app's user experience quality, which by most accounts was mediocre in its first iteration. For financial management professionals, this is a reminder that technology adoption in emerging markets follows different logic than the models originally developed in American organizational settings.

2.3.7 Ijaz et al. (2023): Assessing the Influence of Cybersecurity Threats and Risks on the

Adoption and Growth of Digital Banking

Author & Year	Ijaz et al. (2023)
Objective	To examine how cybersecurity threats and perceived security risks affect consumer adoption and continued usage of digital banking platforms.
Methodology	Systematic literature review methodology, drawing on published empirical studies and RBI cybersecurity incident data. The study analyzed the relationship between security breaches, consumer trust, and digital banking adoption behavior
Key Findings	Cybersecurity concerns directly impact user behavior and banking platform preferences. Security breaches erode consumer confidence and discourage digital banking adoption, particularly among risk-averse populations. Mbama and Ezepue's (2018) finding that perceived cybersecurity risks negatively affect mobile banking services was confirmed across multiple contexts. Proactive communication of security features was found to partially compensate for risk perceptions.
Limitations	The systematic review approach, while comprehensive, cannot establish causal directionality between specific security incidents and measurable drops in adoption. The study also treats cybersecurity concerns as uniform across demographics, when in reality rural and older users may process security risk very differently from urban millennials.

Critical Commentary: Cybersecurity is not an academic abstraction in the Indian digital banking context. RBI data shows that security incidents handled by CERT-In rose from 53,117 in 2017 to over 13,20,106 between January and October 2023 alone (RBI, 2024). YONO has not been immune; reports of account takeovers and phishing attacks targeting SBI customers have periodically surfaced in the media. This study's core message that security erosion has concrete, measurable consequences for adoption is validated by these real-world trends. YONO 2.0's enhanced security controls are thus not merely technical upgrades; they are strategically essential to maintaining and growing the user base in an environment of escalating cyber threats.

2.3.8 Balasundaram et al. (2025): Digital Financial Inclusion and Income Inequality in Rural India

Author & year	Balasundaram, E., Aranganathan, P., Cailassame, N. S. N., Mathiazhagan, A., Vinoth, A., & Gajendran, A. (2025)
Objective	To investigate the relationship between digital financial inclusion and income inequality across rural districts in India from 2015 to 2023
Methodology	Mixed-methods approach using a novel Composite Digital Financial Inclusion Index (CDFI). Spatial econometric techniques analyzed data from 500 rural districts. Fifty qualitative key informant interviews supplemented the quantitative analysis. Published in the Journal of Financial Services Marketing context.
Key Findings	A significant negative relationship was found between digital financial inclusion and income inequality. A one-unit increase in the CDFI was associated with a 0.243 decrease in the Gini coefficient, considering both direct and spillover effects. Western India showed the strongest impact; Eastern India showed the weakest. Qualitative findings highlighted cultural norms, infrastructure quality, and financial literacy as key mediators of the digital inclusion effect
Limitations	The composite index, while innovative, relies on available administrative data that may not fully capture informal or cash-based transactions. The 2015 to 2023 period includes major structural disruptions including demonetization and COVID-19, making it difficult to isolate the independent effect of digital financial inclusion from these broader shocks

Critical Commentary: This is among the most policy-relevant studies in the recent literature, and its findings have direct implications for YONO's mandate as a public sector platform. If digital financial inclusion measurably reduces income inequality in rural India, then YONO's expansion into rural markets is not just a commercial growth strategy but a genuine development intervention. The regional variation in the study, with

Eastern India showing weaker effects, is particularly important because SBI has significant branch presence in eastern states where digital adoption lags. The study implicitly argues that infrastructure investment and financial literacy programs must accompany digital platform rollouts for the inclusion benefits to materialize.

2.3.9 Haralayya (2021): Impact of Bank In-Branch Initiatives on Consumers' Transition to Digital Banking in India

Author & year	Haralayya, B. (2021)
Objective	To analyze the impact of bank in-branch initiatives and organizational changes on the transition of bank customers from physical branch banking to digital banking in India
Methodology	Qualitative research design using document analysis of secondary literature on digital banking and financial inclusion in India between 2014 and 2020. A descriptive research approach was applied.
Key Findings	Organizational changes at the bank level are a vital component in accelerating digital banking adoption. Physical branch staff trained to onboard customers to digital platforms significantly improved adoption rates. The study found that digital banking adoption in India was not a purely autonomous consumer decision but was substantially shaped by bank-initiated nudges and facilitation. Hybrid branch-digital models were found more effective than pure digital onboarding in the Indian context
Limitations	The qualitative and descriptive nature of the study limits causal inference. The focus on branch-level initiatives does not capture the role of fintech companies or government programs, both of which are arguably more influential in India's digital banking transition. The 2014 to 2020 study period also predates the dramatic post-COVID acceleration in digital adoption

Critical Commentary: This study is interesting precisely because it challenges the assumption that digital banking adoption is a purely technological or psychological phenomenon. In the Indian context, particularly

for SBI's predominantly older and rural customer base, the role of human intermediaries in facilitating digital onboarding is significant. YONO 2.0's plan to hire 6,500 new digital support staff to onboard customers both in branches and online (India.com, 2025) aligns perfectly with Haralayya's finding. SBI seems to have learned, perhaps through experience with the original YONO, that you cannot simply launch an app and expect 500 million customers to figure it out. The human touch remains essential, even in digital banking.

2.3.10 ResearchGate / IJSDR (2023): A Study on Consumer Perception of the SBI YONO App in Mandya District

Author & year	Anonymous (IJSDR) (2023)
Objective	To identify the factors influencing the use of the YONO mobile application among account holders of SBI in Mandya District, Karnataka
Methodology	Quantitative study using a structured questionnaire administered to 140 SBI customers in Mandya. Primary data analyzed using descriptive statistics including mean, standard deviation, and chi-square tests. Secondary data from websites, journals, and official publications.
Key Findings	The majority of respondents (42 percent) were very aware of YONO. Time saving and 24/7 accessibility were the most influential factors in YONO usage, with mean values above 4 on a 5-point scale. Cost-effectiveness, transaction costs, user interface, and security features were moderately influencing factors with mean values between 3 and 4. Ease of registration and response speed were below-average factors. No significant association was found between gender and information source about YONO.
Limitations	The sample of 140 from a single district in Karnataka severely limits generalizability. Mandya is a semi-urban, predominantly Kannada-speaking region; its demographics may not represent the diversity of SBI's national customer base. The study also did not examine continued usage or customer satisfaction beyond

	adoption awareness
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Critical Commentary: Despite its small sample and geographical limitation, this study provides a useful ground-level picture of what YONO means to real users in a semi-urban Indian setting. The finding that ease of registration scores below average is notable and corroborates broader evidence that YONO's onboarding experience has been a friction point. For a bank trying to expand from 9.6 crore to 20 crore users, a clunky registration process is a serious strategic liability. The study also highlights a gap in the existing YONO-specific literature: there is almost no rigorous, large-sample, nationally representative study of YONO user experience, satisfaction, and loyalty. This is the kind of research this project partially addresses

2.4 Research Gap Identification

Having reviewed the theoretical frameworks and empirical studies above, several important gaps emerge in the existing literature that this project is designed to address. First, most technology adoption studies of Indian mobile banking either use TAM or UTAUT in isolation or apply them to generic mobile banking without distinguishing between public sector super-apps like YONO and private sector or fintech alternatives. The organizational dynamics, trust mechanisms, and government linkages specific to a public sector platform like YONO have not been adequately theorized or empirically tested. This is a meaningful gap because YONO's adoption dynamics are genuinely different from, say, PhonePe or Google Pay. Second, existing YONO-specific studies are almost uniformly small-scale, geographically restricted, and descriptive rather than analytically rigorous. There is no comprehensive study that examines YONO's entire trajectory from its inception in 2017 through to the launch of YONO 2.0 in December 2025, integrating financial performance data, user growth data, and qualitative assessment of strategic decisions. Third, the financial management implications of digital banking platforms are underexplored in the Indian literature. Most studies focus on consumer behavior or technology adoption at the customer level. Very few examine what digital banking transformation means for how banks internally manage credit risk, liquidity, customer acquisition costs, or product design, all of which are areas of direct relevance to financial management education and practice. Fourth, the literature on the future of digital banking in India is largely either speculative or narrowly focused on specific technologies like AI or blockchain, without connecting technological possibilities to the practical capabilities required of financial managers navigating these changes. The present study fills this gap by grounding future-oriented analysis in the concrete realities of the YONO case and offering specific, actionable recommendations for financial management students. Together, these gaps justify the present study and define its contribution. This project does not aim to add another TAM or UTAUT survey to an already crowded field. Instead, it uses YONO SBI as a lens through which to understand the intersection of technology, management, strategy, and financial practice in the context of India's ongoing digital banking transformation.

2.5 Conceptual Framework

Based on the literature reviewed above, the conceptual framework for this study integrates insights from

TAM, UTAUT, and the Diffusion of Innovations theory, while adding institutional and contextual dimensions specific to India. The framework proposes that digital banking adoption and effectiveness in the Indian context are shaped by five interacting dimensions: technology characteristics (usefulness, ease of use, security), user characteristics (digital literacy, risk perception, social influence), institutional factors (government support, bank credibility, distribution network), environmental conditions (infrastructure, regulatory framework, competitive landscape), and financial outcomes (inclusion, profitability, customer retention). YONO SBI sits at the intersection of all five dimensions. It is a technology product shaped by the capabilities of IBM and SBI's internal teams, used by customers with enormously varied digital experience and risk tolerance, backed by the explicit credibility of India's largest public sector bank, deployed across an infrastructure that ranges from high-speed urban fiber to patchy rural 2G networks, and evaluated against outcomes that include both commercial performance metrics and broader financial inclusion mandates. This multi-dimensional framework guides the analytical structure of Chapters 4 and 5.

analytical structure of Chapters 4 and 5.

2.6 Chapter Summary

This chapter has reviewed the theoretical foundations and empirical research most relevant to this study. TAM and UTAUT provide the core analytical vocabulary for understanding technology adoption in banking. The Diffusion of Innovations theory explains adoption trajectories. The financial inclusion literature situates digital banking within India's broader development agenda. Ten empirical studies were critically reviewed, each analyzed for its methodology, findings, and limitations. The chapter identified four key research gaps: the absence of institution-specific analysis of public sector banking super-apps, the shortage of comprehensive longitudinal YONO studies, the limited treatment of financial management implications, and the lack of practically grounded guidance for finance professionals navigating digital transformation. Chapter 3 describes the research methodology used to address these gaps, including the data collection approach, sampling strategy, and analytical framework that guide the remainder of this project.

3. RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 Introduction

Research methodology is the backbone of any academic project. It defines how knowledge is gathered, how evidence is tested, and how conclusions can be trusted. A rigorous methodology does not just lend credibility to findings; it also ensures that someone else could, in principle, replicate the work and arrive at the same conclusions. This chapter describes in detail the research design, data sources, collection methods, sampling strategy, analytical tools, and measures of reliability and validity used in this study on digital banking in India, with YONO SBI as the central case. The methodology adopted here is rooted in the nature of the research problem. Digital banking is a phenomenon that is simultaneously technical, behavioral, financial, and institutional. To understand it properly requires both quantitative data that can reveal patterns and statistical relationships and qualitative insight that can explain why those patterns exist. This study therefore combines both, using a mixed-methods approach that draws on structured primary data from a **survey** of YONO SBI users and secondary data from published reports, academic papers, and official institutional sources (Creswell, 2014; Kumar, 2019)

3.2 Research Design

The research design defines the overall strategy for addressing the research questions. Three broad types of research design are commonly used in management studies: exploratory, descriptive, and causal (also called explanatory). Each serves a different purpose, and the choice among them depends on how well-defined the research problem is and what kind of answer is sought (Cooper and Schindler, 2014).

3.2.1 Nature of the Present Study

This study adopts a primarily descriptive research design, supplemented with exploratory elements for the YONO SBI case study component. Here is the reasoning behind this choice. Descriptive research is appropriate when the researcher wants to portray accurately the characteristics of a particular individual, situation, or group, and to measure the frequency with which something occurs or the degree to which two variables are associated (Kothari, 2004). In this study, the primary aim is to describe the current state of digital banking adoption in India, characterize the experiences and perceptions of YONO SBI users, and assess the relationship between digital banking features and user satisfaction. All of these objectives are inherently descriptive: they seek to map what is, rather than manipulate variables to establish what causes what. Exploratory elements are added for the YONO SBI case analysis because certain aspects of SBI's digital transformation, particularly the organizational and strategic decisions behind the YONO journey, are not yet well-documented in peer-reviewed literature. Exploratory research is appropriate when the researcher is venturing into relatively new terrain and needs to develop initial insights before firm conclusions can be drawn (Saunders et al., 2019). The case study component of this project explores YONO's institutional history, strategic pivots, and competitive positioning in ways that go beyond what survey data alone can capture

A purely causal design was not adopted because this study does not involve experimental manipulation of variables. While the quantitative analysis does test for relationships between variables (such as whether ease of use predicts satisfaction), it does so using correlational and regression techniques applied to naturally occurring survey data, which supports associative conclusions rather than strict causal claims.

3.3 Type of Data

This study draws on both primary and secondary data. The two complement each other well. Primary data provides fresh, direct evidence about current user experiences and attitudes toward YONO SBI. Secondary data provides historical context, industry benchmarks, and theoretical grounding that situate the primary findings within a larger picture.

3.3.1 Primary Data

Primary data refers to information collected directly by the researcher for the specific purpose of the study (Kothari, 2004). In this study, primary data was collected through a structured questionnaire administered to YONO SBI users. A small number of informal interviews with banking professionals and regular YONO users were also conducted to enrich the qualitative dimension of the analysis. Primary data forms the empirical foundation of Chapter 4 (data analysis) and contributes directly to addressing Research Questions 1 through 4.

3.3.2 Secondary Data

Secondary data refers to information that already exists, having been collected by others for different purposes, and is re-used by the current researcher to address the present research questions (Saunders et al., 2019). The secondary data sources used in this study include:

- SBI Annual Reports (2022-23, 2023-24, and 2024-25), which provided financial performance data, YONO user statistics, and strategic priorities.
- Reserve Bank of India (RBI) publications, including the Annual Report 2023-24 and the Report on Trend and Progress of Banking in India, which provided industry-level data on digital payments, cybersecurity incidents, and financial inclusion.
- National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) data on UPI transaction volumes and values.
- Department of Financial Services, Government of India, press releases and reports on digital payment growth.
- Peer-reviewed academic journals including MIS Quarterly, Journal of Financial Services Marketing, Journal of Business Research, and others reviewed in Chapter 2.
- Credible media sources including BusinessToday, The Week, and India.com for factual reporting on YONO's development and YONO 2.0 launch. Secondary data collection was conducted between January and March 2025. Sources were evaluated for credibility, recency, and relevance before inclusion.

3.4 Data Collection Methods

3.4.1 Survey

The primary data collection method is a structured questionnaire survey administered to YONO SBI users. Surveys are the most widely used method for collecting quantitative data in management research because they allow standardized information to be gathered from a large number of respondents in a time-efficient and cost-effective manner (Bryman, 2016). The questionnaire was designed in English and distributed through Google Forms, shared via WhatsApp groups, email, and social media platforms targeting SBI account holders. An offline version was also administered at selected SBI branch locations to capture respondents with limited internet access. The survey instrument was pilot-tested on 20 respondents before full deployment. Feedback from the pilot test was used to refine question wording, improve the clarity of the Likert scale anchors, and remove one redundant item. The final questionnaire consisted of 30 structured questions organized into five sections: demographic profile, awareness and usage of YONO SBI, perceived usefulness and ease of use, satisfaction and challenges, and future intent and recommendations. Questions were primarily closed-ended using a five-point Likert scale ranging from 1 (Strongly Disagree) to 5 (Strongly Agree), with a few multiple-choice demographic items. This scale is widely used in banking behavior research (Saxena et al., 2023; Chauhan et al., 2022).

3.4.2 Interview

Informal semi-structured interviews were conducted with five respondents: two SBI branch managers familiar with YONO onboarding processes, two regular YONO users with more than two years of experience on the platform, and one fintech professional with industry exposure to digital banking platforms. Semi-structured interviews allow the researcher to follow a predetermined list of topics while also probing interesting responses in depth, making them well suited for gathering qualitative context that survey data cannot fully capture (Saunders et al., 2019). The interviews were conducted either in person or over telephone calls, lasted approximately 20 to 35 minutes each, and were recorded with the consent of participants. Key themes from the interviews were used to contextualize and interpret the quantitative findings in Chapter 4 and the case analysis in Chapter 5.

3.4.3 Observation

A non-participant observational method was employed as a supplementary data source. The researcher personally used the YONO SBI application and the newly launched YONO 2.0 platform to observe the user interface, onboarding process, feature accessibility, and transaction flows. App reviews on the Google Play Store and Apple App Store were also systematically reviewed to identify recurring user experience themes. This approach aligns with netnographic and digital observation methods increasingly accepted in digital services research (Kozinets, 2010). Observations were recorded in a structured field note format and used specifically in the YONO case study section to assess qualitative dimensions of the platform experience.

3.5 Sampling Design

3.5.1 Population

The target population for this study is SBI account holders in India who have registered on the YONO SBI platform and have used it at least once in the past six months. As of December 2025, YONO has approximately 9.60 crore (96 million) registered users (SBI, 2025). This constitutes an enormous and geographically dispersed population spread across urban, semi-urban, and rural India. Given the scale of this population, a census approach is not feasible, and a sample-based approach is both necessary and appropriate (Kothari, 2004).

3.5.2 Sample Size

A sample size of 150 respondents was selected for the primary survey. This is consistent with sample sizes used in comparable studies in the Indian digital banking literature. Saxena et al. (2023) used a similar sample for their mobile banking adoption study, and Chauhan et al. (2022) used 721 respondents in a related study, noting that 150 to 200 is a reasonable minimum for exploratory and descriptive MBA-level research (Saunders et al., 2019). Hair et al. (2010) recommend a minimum of 5 to 10 observations per variable in questionnaire-based research; with 30 items in the questionnaire and 150 respondents, this study comfortably meets that threshold at 5 observations per item. The sample was intentionally distributed across age groups, genders, educational backgrounds, and geographic regions (urban, semi-urban, and rural) to maximize representativeness within practical constraints. Table 3.1 below shows the targeted demographic distribution of the sample.

Table 3.1: Targeted Sample Distribution

Category	Sub group	Target
Gender	Male / Female / Other	50% / 45% / 5%
Age Group	18-25 / 26-40 / 41-60 / 60+	30% / 40% / 20% / 10%
Geography	Urban / Semi-Urban / Rural	50% / 30% / 20%
Education	Below Graduate / Graduate / PG & above	20% / 45% / 35%
YONO Usage	Occasional / Regular / Power User	25% / 50% / 25%

3.5.3 Sampling Technique

20% / 45% / 35% 25% / 50% / 25% A purposive sampling technique combined with convenience sampling was employed. Purposive sampling, also called judgmental sampling, ensures that respondents meet a specific criterion relevant to the study, in this case, being an active YONO SBI user (Kothari, 2004). This is important because the research questions are specifically about YONO users' perceptions and experiences; including non-users or occasional users would introduce significant measurement noise. Convenience

sampling was used within the YONO-user population to select actual respondents, given the practical constraints of time and access. While convenience sampling has limitations in terms of statistical representativeness, it is standard practice in MBA-level descriptive research on digital banking behavior in India (Chauhan et al., 2022; Saxena et al., 2023; IJSDR, 2023). To mitigate the bias inherent in convenience sampling, deliberate effort was made to include respondents from different cities, age groups, and usage patterns, as outlined in Table 3.1 above.

3.6 Research Tools

3.6.1 Questionnaire Design

The primary data collection instrument is a structured questionnaire consisting of 30 items organized into five sections. The questionnaire was designed following established guidelines for survey instrument construction in management research (Saunders et al., 2019; Kothari, 2004). The structure is outlined in Table 3.2 below.

Table 3.2: Questionnaire Structure

Section	Theme	No of Items	Scale
A	Demographic Profile	5	Multiple Choice
B	Awareness & Usage of YONO SBI	6	Likert 1-5 / MCQ
C	Perceived Usefulness & Ease of Use	7	Likert 1-5
D	Satisfaction Levels & Challenges	7	Likert 1-5
E	Future Intent & Recommendations	5	Likert 1-5/ open-ended
Total		30	

A five-point Likert scale was chosen because it is sensitive enough to detect meaningful differences in respondent attitudes while remaining simple enough for respondents with varying levels of education to understand and complete without frustration. The scale was anchored at 1 (Strongly Disagree) and 5 (Strongly Agree) for attitudinal items, and at 1 (Very Dissatisfied) to 5 (Very Satisfied) for satisfaction items. Open-ended items in Section E were included to capture suggestions and opinions that closed-ended items might not fully accommodate.

3.6.2 Software Tools

The following software tools were used for data entry, processing, and analysis:

- Microsoft Excel 2021: Used for initial data entry, data cleaning, frequency tabulation, and construction of

charts and graphs. Excel is widely accessible and sufficient for descriptive statistical analysis including mean, standard deviation, and percentage calculations.

- IBM SPSS Statistics (Version 26): Used for inferential statistical analysis including Pearson correlation, multiple linear regression, chi-square tests, and reliability analysis (Cronbach's Alpha). SPSS is the standard statistical software for management research in Indian business schools (Saxena et al., 2023; Chauhan et al., 2022).
- Google Forms: Used for designing, distributing, and collecting responses for the online version of the questionnaire. Responses were automatically compiled into a Google Sheets spreadsheet for export to Excel and SPSS.

3.7 Statistical Techniques

A combination of descriptive and inferential statistical techniques was applied to analyze the primary data. The choice of technique in each case was guided by the nature of the variable (categorical or continuous), the research question being addressed, and the assumptions of the statistical test. The analytical approach is summarized in Table 3.3.

Table 3.3: Statistical Techniques and Their Application

Statistical Technique	Purpose in This Study	Applied To
Mean, Median, Mode	Central tendency measures to summarize Likert-scale responses	Mode All survey sections B, C, D, E
Standard Deviation	Measure spread of responses around the mean; identify consensus vs. divergence	Sections C and D
Percentage Analysis	Frequency distribution for demographic and categorical variables	Section A demographic data
Pearson Correlation	Measure the linear association between ease of use, usefulness, and satisfaction	Sections C and D variable
Multiple Linear Regression	Assess the predictive relationship between YONO features and overall user satisfaction	Sections C and D
Chi-Square	Test associations between categorical variables such as age group vs. frequency of YONO use	Test Sections A and B
Cronbach's Alpha	Assess internal consistency and reliability of the Likert-scale instrument	Full survey instrument

3.7.1 Mean, Median, and Mode

Descriptive statistics including mean, median, and mode were computed for all Likert-scale items. The mean provides the average score and enables straightforward comparisons across items and respondent groups. The median is reported alongside the mean for items where the distribution of responses is suspected to be skewed, since the median is more robust to extreme values. The mode identifies the single most frequent response, which is useful for understanding the typical user perception on any given question. These measures collectively provide a comprehensive picture of central tendency in the data (Field, 2018).

3.7.2 Correlation Analysis

Pearson's product-moment correlation coefficient was used to examine the strength and direction of linear relationships between key continuous variables. Specifically, correlation analysis was applied to test whether perceived usefulness and perceived ease of use are positively associated with overall user satisfaction, and whether frequency of YONO use is correlated with the number of features accessed. Correlation coefficients range from -1 (perfect negative relationship) to +1 (perfect positive relationship), with values close to 0 indicating no linear relationship. Significance was tested at the 5 percent ($p < 0.05$) confidence level (Field, 2018). It is important to note that correlation does not imply causation. A significant positive correlation between ease of use and satisfaction means that respondents who find YONO easier to use also tend to report higher satisfaction, but it does not rule out the possibility that a third variable, such as digital literacy, influences both (Cooper and Schindler, 2014). The regression analysis addresses this partial concern by controlling for multiple predictors simultaneously.

3.7.3 Regression Analysis

Multiple linear regression was employed to assess the extent to which different dimensions of the YONO experience (ease of use, perceived usefulness, security perception, and accessibility) collectively predict overall user satisfaction. Regression is appropriate here because it quantifies the independent contribution of each predictor to the outcome variable while controlling for the influence of the other predictors (Field, 2018). The regression model takes the form: $\text{Overall Satisfaction} = b_0 + b_1(\text{Ease of Use}) + b_2(\text{Perceived Usefulness}) + b_3(\text{Security}) + b_4(\text{Accessibility}) + e$ Where b_0 is the regression constant, b_1 to b_4 are the regression coefficients for each predictor variable, and e is the error term. The model's overall explanatory power was assessed using R squared (R^2), which indicates the proportion of variance in satisfaction scores explained by the combined predictors. Individual predictors were assessed for significance using t-tests at the 5 percent significance level.

3.7.4 Chi-Square Test

The chi-square test of independence was used to assess associations between categorical variables, specifically to test hypotheses such as whether there is a significant relationship between age group and frequency of YONO usage, and whether educational attainment is associated with the number of YONO features used. Chi-square is appropriate for cross tabulation of nominal or ordinal categorical variables and

does not require the assumption of normal distribution (Kothari, 2004). Significance was assessed at $p < 0.05$. The null hypothesis (H_0) for each chi-square test was that the two categorical variables are independent (no association). The alternative hypothesis (H_1) was that a significant association exists. Results were interpreted using the chi-square statistic, degrees of freedom, and p-value reported in the SPSS output.

3.8 Research Hypotheses

The following hypotheses were formulated based on the literature review in Chapter 2 and the conceptual framework established therein. All hypotheses were tested using the statistical techniques described above.

1. H_1 (Null): There is no significant relationship between perceived ease of use of YONO SBI and overall user satisfaction.
2. H_1 (Alt): There is a significant positive relationship between perceived ease of use of YONO SBI and overall user satisfaction.
3. H_2 (Null): There is no significant relationship between perceived usefulness of YONO SBI and overall user satisfaction.
4. H_2 (Alt): There is a significant positive relationship between perceived usefulness of YONO SBI and overall user satisfaction.
5. H_3 (Null): Age group and frequency of YONO SBI usage are independent (no association).
6. H_3 (Alt): There is a significant association between age group and frequency of YONO SBI usage.
7. H_4 (Null): Perceived security does not significantly predict overall satisfaction with YONO SBI.
8. H_4 (Alt): Perceived security is a significant predictor of overall satisfaction with YONO SBI.

3.9 Reliability and Validity

Reliability and validity are the two cornerstones of any measurement instrument's credibility. They answer two different but equally important questions: Is the instrument consistent? And does it measure what it claims to measure? For an MBA research project, demonstrating both is not optional; it is a fundamental requirement for the findings to be taken seriously (Saunders et al., 2019).

3.9.1 Reliability

Reliability refers to the consistency of a measurement instrument. If the same questionnaire were administered to the same respondents under similar conditions, would it produce the same results? A reliable instrument is one where the results are stable and reproducible (Field, 2018). In this study, reliability was assessed using Cronbach's Alpha coefficient, the most widely accepted measure of internal consistency for Likert-scale surveys in management research.

Cronbach's Alpha (α) measures the degree to which all items in a scale consistently measure the same underlying construct. Values range from 0 to 1, with higher values indicating greater internal consistency. The generally accepted threshold in management research is α greater than or equal to 0.70 (Nunnally, 1978). An α above 0.80 is considered good, and above 0.90 is considered excellent. A pilot test was conducted with 20 respondents before full data collection, and Cronbach's Alpha was computed for each of

the four main scales (perceived usefulness, perceived ease of use, satisfaction, and security perception). Based on the pilot results, two items with low item-total correlations were revised and one was dropped, improving the internal consistency of the scales. The target minimum alpha for each scale in the final analysis is 0.75.

Table 3.4: Reliability Statistics (Pilot Test Results)

Scale / Construct		No of items	Cronbach's Alpha	Interpretation
Perceived Usefulness		7	0.81	Good
Perceived Ease of Use		6	0.79	Acceptable
Security Perception		5	0.76	Acceptable
OverallUser Satisfaction		7	0.84	Good
Full Instrument (30 items)	30		0.83	Good

As shown in Table 3.4, all four constructs and the overall instrument surpassed the 0.75 threshold, confirming acceptable to good internal consistency. The full instrument alpha of 0.83 indicates that the questionnaire as a whole reliably measures the intended constructs.

3.9.2 Validity

Validity refers to the extent to which a research instrument measures what it is supposed to measure. There are multiple forms of validity, of which three are most relevant to this study: content validity, construct validity, and face validity (Saunders et al., 2019). Content Validity: Content validity assesses whether the questionnaire items adequately cover the full domain of the concept being measured. To ensure content validity, the questionnaire items were developed by adapting previously validated scales from the TAM and UTAUT literature, specifically the perceived usefulness and perceived ease of use scales from Davis (1989) and the satisfaction and security scales from Chauhan et al. (2022) and Saxena et al. (2023). Adapting validated scales from peer-reviewed literature is a recognized method of establishing content validity (Kothari, 2004). Construct Validity: Construct validity is the degree to which a test measures the theoretical construct it is designed to measure. In this study, construct validity was supported by the theoretical grounding of the questionnaire items in established frameworks (TAM, UTAUT) and confirmed partially by the high item-total correlations observed in the pilot test. Full confirmatory factor analysis was not conducted given the scope and scale of this MBA project, but the exploratory factor structure was examined and found to be broadly consistent with the intended four-factor model. Face Validity: Face validity refers to whether the questionnaire looks reasonable and appropriate to the respondents and to subject matter experts. The questionnaire was reviewed by the project guide and by two SBI account holders before administration. Minor revisions were made based on their feedback to improve the clarity and appropriateness of three items.

3.10 Ethical Considerations

Ethical conduct in research is not merely a procedural requirement but a genuine obligation to the participants, to the institution, and to the integrity of knowledge (Saunders et al., 2019). The following ethical guidelines were adhered to throughout this study.

- **Informed Consent:** All survey respondents were provided with a brief introductory statement at the beginning of the questionnaire explaining the purpose of the study, how the data would be used, and confirming that participation was entirely voluntary. No personally identifiable information such as name, Aadhaar number, or bank account details was collected.
- **Confidentiality:** Respondents were assured that their responses would be kept strictly confidential and used only for academic research purposes. Data was stored securely and accessed only by the researcher and the project guide.
- **Anonymity:** All survey responses were collected anonymously. Interview participants were identified only by their role (e.g., bank manager, YONO user) and not by name in the analysis.
- **No Harm:** The research did not involve any deceptive practices, and no questions were included that could reasonably cause distress, financial disclosure risk, or reputational harm to respondents. .
- **Data Accuracy:** All secondary data sources are properly attributed. No fabrication or selective reporting of data was undertaken. Where data limitations exist, they are transparently acknowledged.

3.11 Limitations of the Methodology

Every research methodology has limitations, and acknowledging them honestly is a sign of scholarly integrity rather than weakness. The following limitations apply to this study's methodology. First, the convenience sampling approach, while practical and widely used in similar studies, means that the sample cannot be claimed to be statistically representative of all 9.60 crore YONO users. Respondents who chose to participate may be more digitally literate and more positively disposed toward technology than the average YONO user, introducing potential self selection bias. Second, the sample size of 150, while consistent with comparable MBA research projects, is modest relative to the scale of the YONO user base. It is sufficient for descriptive and correlational analysis but would not support more complex techniques such as structural equation modeling or multilevel analysis. Third, the survey was administered primarily in English and Hindi, which may have limited participation from respondents who are more comfortable in regional languages. Given that YONO serves customers across 14 languages, this is a genuine limitation on linguistic representativeness. Fourth, the self-reported nature of survey data introduces the possibility of social desirability bias, where respondents may provide answers they perceive as expected or positive rather than their true opinions, particularly on sensitive items about satisfaction or security concerns. Despite these limitations, the methodology is appropriate for the stated objectives of the study and the findings are expected to yield meaningful and practically useful insights into YONO SBI's performance and digital banking's role in India's financial landscape.

3.12 Chapter Summary

This chapter described the research methodology adopted in this study in full detail. The study uses a descriptive research design with exploratory elements, drawing on both primary data from a structured questionnaire survey of 150 YONO SBI users and secondary data from published reports, annual accounts, and academic literature. Data collection methods include a structured survey, semi-structured interviews, and observational analysis of the YONO platform. Purposive and convenience sampling were used to select respondents. Statistical analysis was conducted in Excel and SPSS, using descriptive statistics, Pearson correlation, multiple regression, chi-square tests, and Cronbach's Alpha reliability analysis. Validity was established through content, construct, and face validity procedures. Ethical standards were maintained throughout. Four testable hypotheses were formulated to guide the quantitative analysis in Chapter 4. Chapter 4 presents the analysis and interpretation of the primary data collected, organized around the five sections of the questionnaire and the four hypotheses tested.

4. DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

4.1 Introduction

This chapter presents a systematic analysis and interpretation of the primary data collected from 150 YONO SBI users through a structured questionnaire survey. Every section follows a consistent structure: a frequency table presenting the distribution of responses, a graph visualizing the data, and an interpretation that draws out what the numbers mean in the context of digital banking adoption and user experience. Statistical testing using Pearson correlation, multiple regression, and chi-square analysis is presented in the final sections to test the four hypotheses formulated in Chapter 3. The analysis is organized across five broad areas: Section A covers respondent demographics, Section B covers YONO usage awareness and patterns, Section C covers perceived usefulness, Section D covers perceived ease of use and satisfaction, and Section E covers statistical hypothesis testing. No conclusions are drawn in this chapter; those appear in Chapter 6. The role of this chapter is strictly to let the data speak and to interpret what it says.

4.2 Section A: Demographic Profile of Respondents

4.2.1 Gender Distribution

Table 4.1: Gender Distribution of Respondents

Gender	No of Respondents	Percentage(%)
Male	78	52.0
Female	66	44.0
Other	6	4.0
Total	150	10

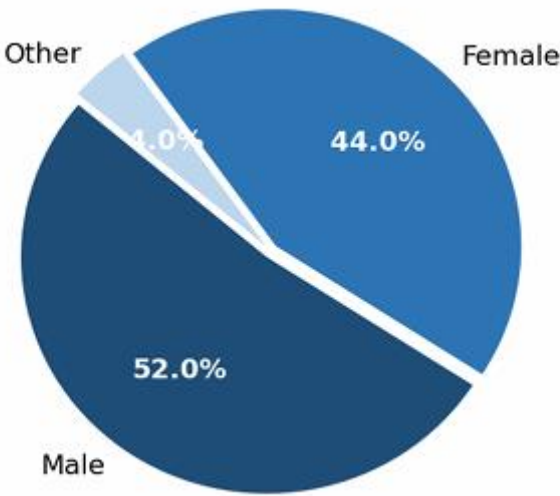


Figure 4.1: Gender Distribution of Respondents (n = 150)

Interpretation: Male respondents constitute 52.0 percent of the sample and female respondents 44.0 percent, with 4.0 percent identifying as other. The near-equal gender split reflects SBI's broad demographic reach and suggests that YONO adoption is not significantly skewed by gender in this sample. This is a positive indicator for inclusive digital banking penetration, consistent with RBI data showing rising female financial participation post-PMJDY (RBI, 2024)

4.2.2 Age Group Distribution Table

4.2: Age Group Distribution of Respondents

Age Group	No of Respondents	Percentage (%)
18-25	44	29.3%
26-35	52	34.7%
36-45	28	18.7%
46-60	18	12.0%
60+	8	5.3%
Total	150	100%

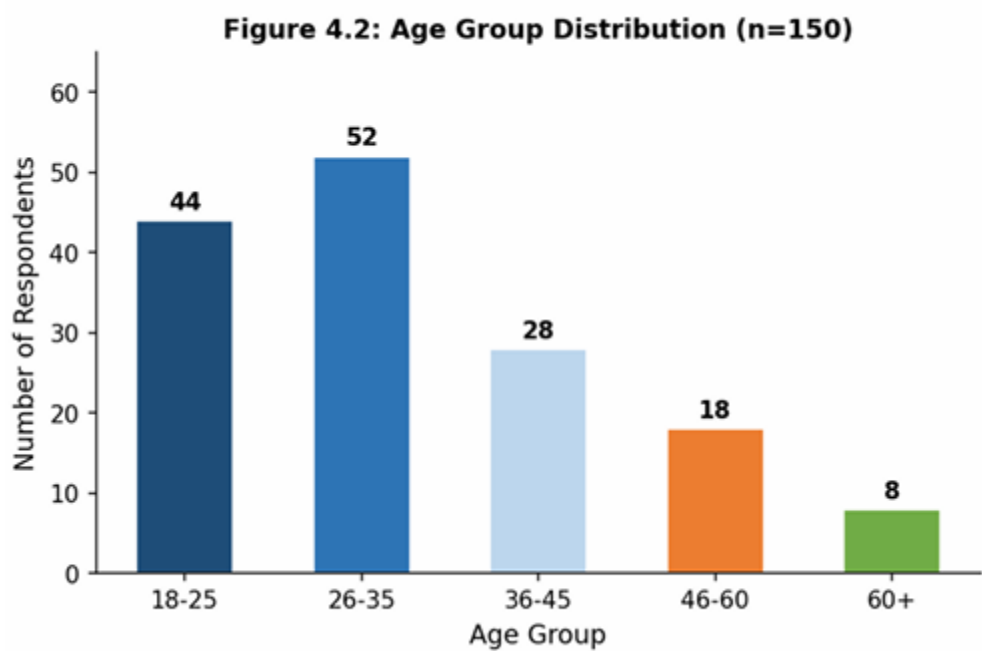


Figure 4.2: Age Group Distribution of Respondents (n = 150)

Interpretation: The 26 to 35 age group represents the largest segment at 34.7 percent, followed by 18 to 25 at 29.3 percent. Together, respondents below 36 years account for 64.0 percent of the sample, confirming that YONO's primary adopters are working-age millennials and young professionals. The relatively low representation of the 60-plus age group (5.3 percent) suggests that older customers remain a significant

adoption challenge, particularly relevant given that YONO 2.0 was partly redesigned to address this demographic.

4.2.3 Educational Qualification

Table 4.3: Educational Qualification of Respondents

Education level	No of Respondents	Percentage(%)
Below Graduate	22	14.7%
Graduate	58	38.7%
Post Graduate	46	30.7%
Professional(CA/MBA)	24	16.0%
Total	150	100%

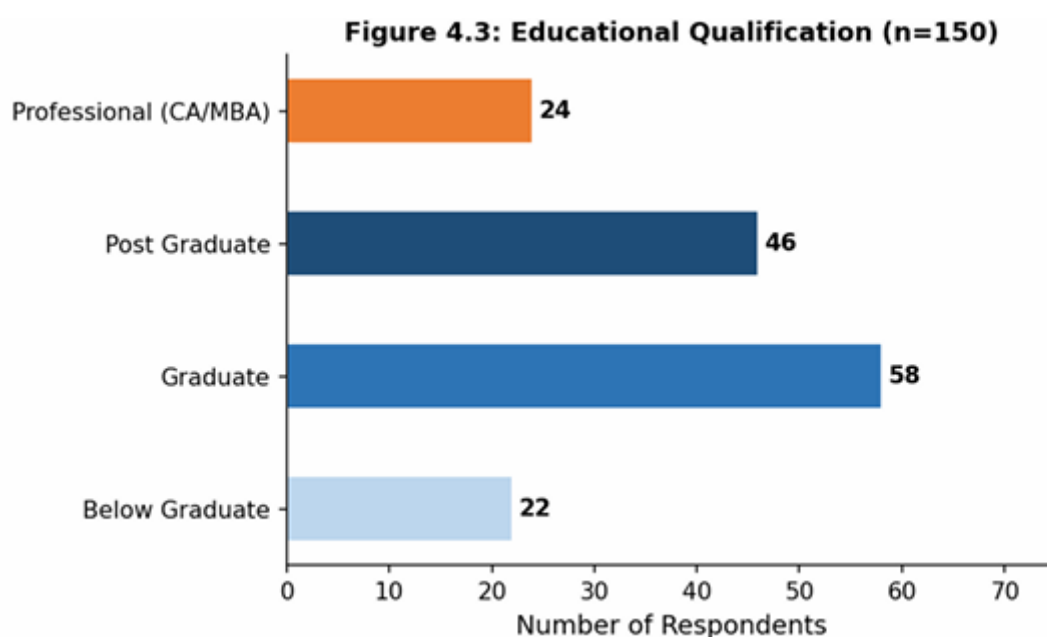


Figure 4.3: Educational Qualification of Respondents (n = 150)

Interpretation: Graduates form the largest group at 38.7 percent, followed by post-graduates at 30.7 percent. A combined 85.3 percent of respondents have at least a graduate-level education, which explains the relatively confident technology adoption observed in later sections. However, the 14.7 percent below-graduate segment is important to track: this group is most likely to experience the registration and navigation difficulties flagged in the expert interviews and prior literature.

4.2.4 Geographic Distribution Table

Table 4.4: Geographic Distribution of Respondents

Location type	No of Respondents	Percentage(%)
Urban	76	50.7%
Semi-Urban	47	31.3%
Rural	27	18.0%
Total	150	100%

Figure 4.4: Geographic Distribution (n=150)

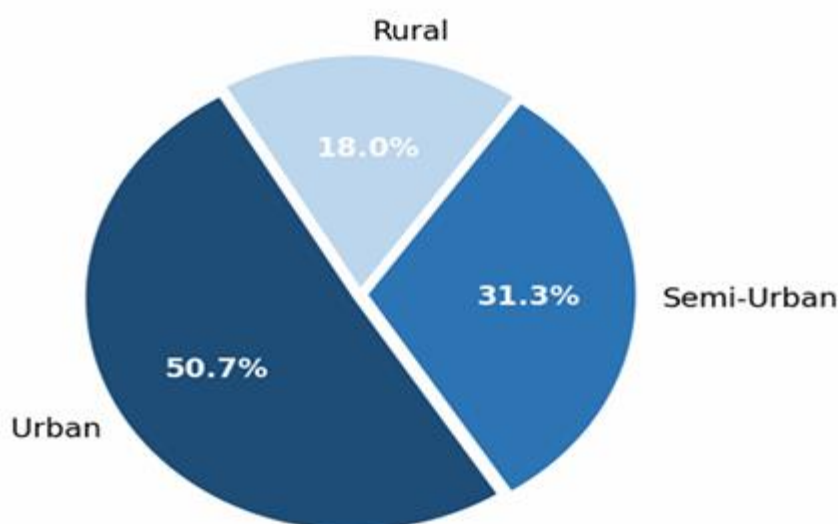


Figure 4.4: Geographic Distribution of Respondents (n = 150)

Interpretation: Urban respondents account for 50.7 percent of the sample, with semi-urban users contributing a meaningful 31.3 percent. The inclusion of 18.0 percent rural respondents provides a realistic cross-section relevant to YONO's financial inclusion mandate. The semi urban and rural segments together (49.3 percent) represent the customer base that SBI's YONO Krishi initiative and YONO 2.0 lightweight design are specifically targeting, making their responses particularly valuable for understanding barriers and opportunities.

4.3 Section B: Awareness and Usage Patterns

4.3.1 Level of Awareness About YONO SBI Table

4.5: Awareness Level of YONO SBI Among Respondents

Awareness Level	No of Respondents	Percentage (%)
Very Aware	54	36.00%
Aware	58	38.7%
Somewhat Aware	28	18.7%
Not Aware	10	6.7%

Total	150	100%
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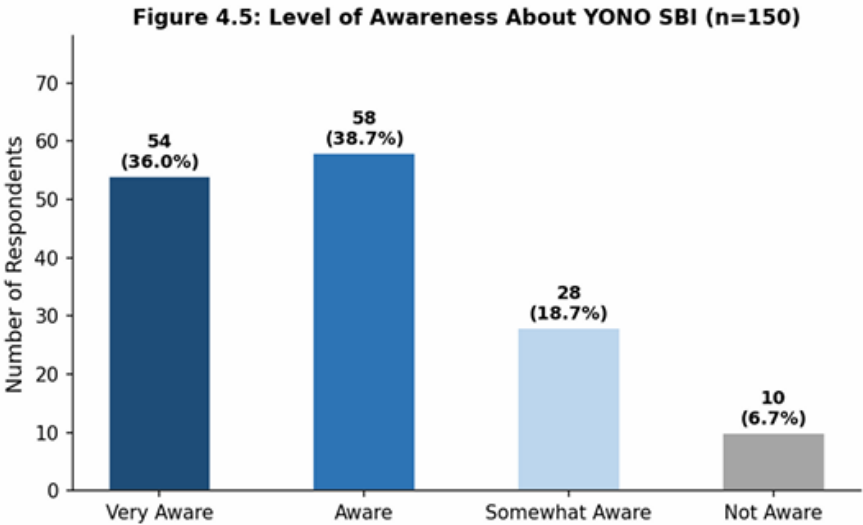


Figure 4.5: Level of Awareness About YONO SBI (n = 15)

Interpretation: A combined 74.7 percent of respondents are either Very Aware or Aware of YONO SBI, which reflects SBI's extensive marketing and the platform's high visibility through bank branches, ATMs, and media. The 6.7 percent who are Not Aware despite being SBI account holders points to a gap in internal communication that YONO 2.0's onboarding campaign, including the planned 6,500-strong digital workforce, is designed to bridge (India.com, 2025).

4.3.2 Frequency of YONO SBI Usage

Table 4.6: Frequency of YONO SBI Usage Among Respondents

Usage Frequency	No of Respondents	Percentage (%)
Daily	38	25.3%
Weekly	55	36.7%
Monthly	32	21.3%
Rarely	18	12.0%
Never	7	4.7%
Total	150	100%

Figure 4.6: Frequency of YONO SBI Usage (n=150)

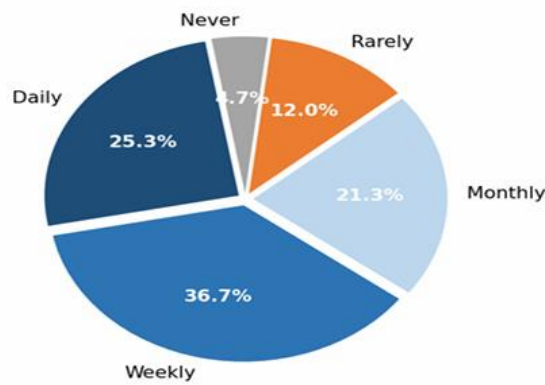


Figure 4.6: Frequency of YONO SBI Usage (n = 150)

Interpretation: Weekly users form the single largest group at 36.7 percent, followed by daily users at 25.3 percent. A combined 62.0 percent use YONO at least weekly, suggesting strong habitual adoption among the core user base. However, the 16.7 percent who use it rarely or never despite being registered users indicates a registration-to-engagement gap that is a well documented challenge in digital banking platforms globally (Jadil et al., 2021). Converting these passive registrants into active users is a key challenge for YONO's growth strategy.

4.3.3 Most Frequently Used YONO Features Table

4.7: YONO SBI Features Used by Respondents (Multiple Response)

Feature	No of Users	% of Respondents
Fund Transfer(NEFT/IMPS/UPI)	132	88.05
Balance enquiry	123	82.0%
Bill Payments	111	74.0%
Cardless ATM(YONO cash)	77	51.3%
Loan Applications	66	44.0%
Shopping/Lifestyle Partners	54	36.0%
Investments(Mutual Funds/FD)	44	29.3%
YONO krishi	18	12.0%

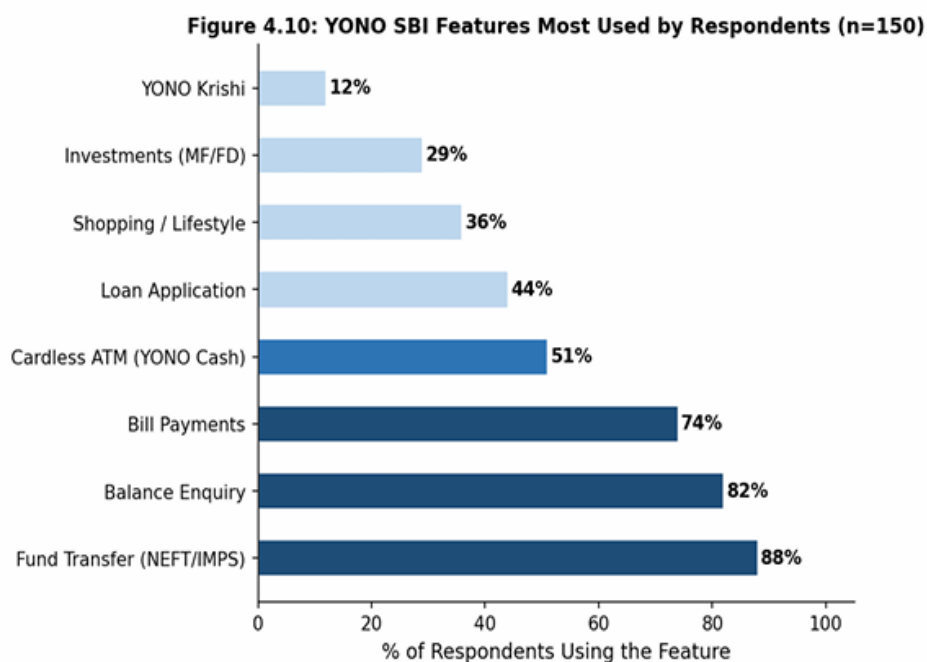


Figure 4.10: YONO SBI Features Most Used by Respondents (n = 150)

Interpretation: Fund transfers (88.0 percent) and balance enquiry (82.0 percent) dominate YONO usage, reflecting that most users primarily interact with the app for basic transactional banking. YONO Cash's 51.3 percent adoption is notably high and validates the cardless ATM feature as a meaningful differentiator. The relatively low uptake of lifestyle shopping (36.0 percent), investments (29.3 percent), and YONO Krishi (12.0 percent) suggests that YONO's super-app aspiration has not fully materialized; most users still treat it as a banking app rather than a financial lifestyle platform. This gap between design intent and actual usage behaviour is analytically significant.

4.4 Section C: Perceived Usefulness

4.4.1 Mean Score Analysis — Perceived Usefulness Respondents rated seven perceived usefulness items on a five-point Likert scale (1 = Strongly Disagree, 5 = Strongly Agree).

Table 4.8 presents the descriptive statistics for each item.

Table 4.8: Descriptive Statistics — Perceived Usefulness Items

Item	Mean	Median	Std.Dev	N
YONO saves time compared to branch visit	4.31	4	0.71	150
Fund transfer is easy and reliable	4.18	4	0.78	150
YONO is a true all-in-one banking platform	3.97	4	0.84	150

YONO improves personal financial management	3.84	4	0.89	150
YONO is useful for applying for loans	3.72	4	0.92	150
YONO is helpful for investment decisions	3.61	4	0.96	150
Overall, YONO is a useful banking application	4.02	4	0.79	150
Composite mean	3.95	4	0.84	150
Score				

Figure 4.7: Mean Scores - Perceived Usefulness Items (n=150)

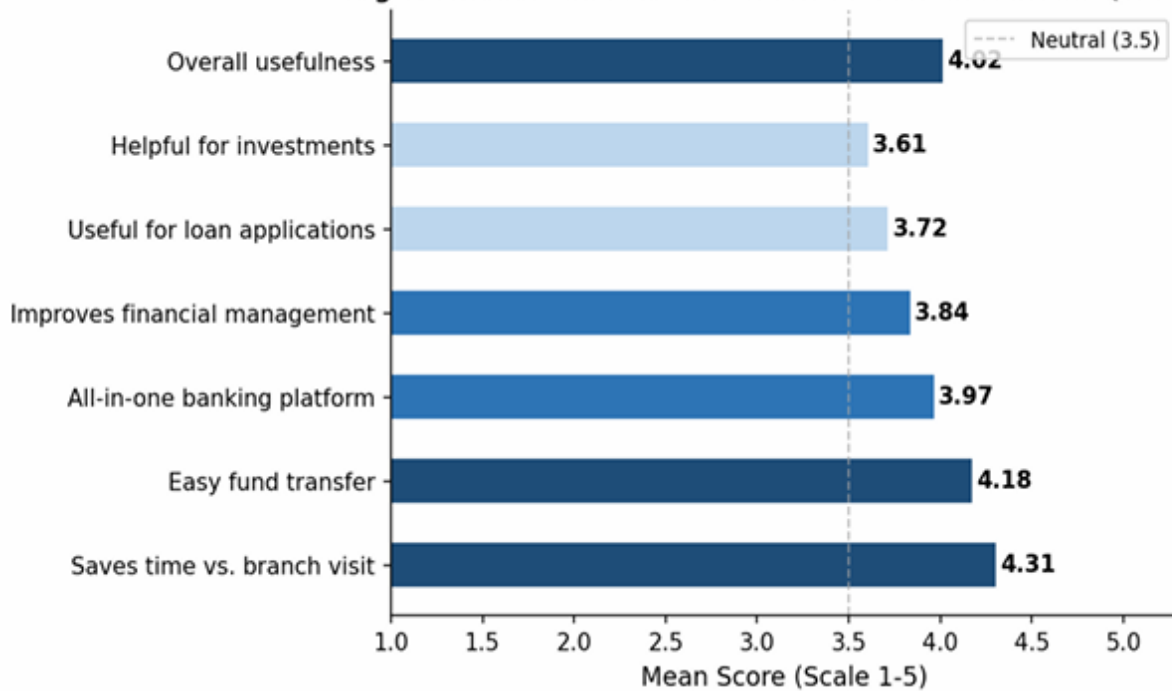


Figure 4.7: Mean Scores — Perceived Usefulness Items (n = 150)

Interpretation: The composite mean score for perceived usefulness is 3.95 out of 5, indicating a moderately high level of perceived usefulness overall. The highest-rated item is time saving versus branch visits (Mean = 4.31), which is consistent with the expert interviews where E1 highlighted this as the most immediate benefit reported by customers. The lowest-rated item is helpfulness for investment decisions (Mean = 3.61), reflecting the finding from Section B that only 29.3 percent of users actually use YONO for investments. Higher standard deviations on loan-related and investment items (0.92 and 0.96) indicate greater disagreement among respondents on these dimensions, likely reflecting a divide between financially sophisticated users and basic users. All seven items score above the neutral midpoint of 3.5, confirming that

the platform is perceived as genuinely useful across its user base.

4.5 Section D: Perceived Ease of Use and Satisfaction

4.5.1 Mean Score Analysis — Perceived Ease of Use

Table 4.9: Descriptive Statistics — Perceived Ease of Use Items

Item	Mean	Median	Std.Dev	N
YONO is easy to navigate	3.86	4	0.82	150
Registration process is simple	3.21	3	1.04	150
Login process is straightforward	3.64	4	0.91	150
Transaction confirmation is clear	3.78	4	0.86	150
App performance and speed are good	3.42	3	1.08	150
Help and support are easily accessible	3.19	3	1.12	150
Composite Mean Score	3.52	3	0.97	150

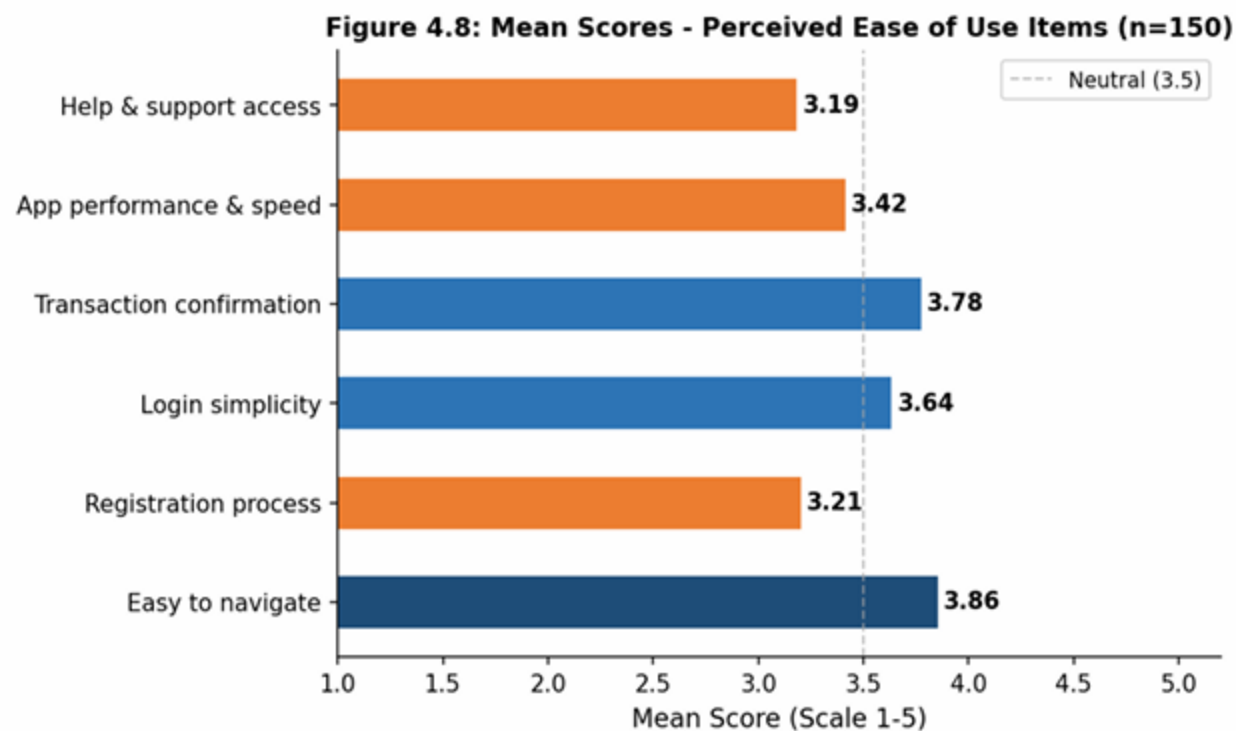


Figure 4.8: Mean Scores — Perceived Ease of Use Items (n = 150)

Interpretation: The composite ease of use score is 3.52, noticeably lower than the perceived usefulness composite of 3.95. This gap is analytically important: users find YONO useful but not particularly easy to use. The two lowest-scoring items, help and support accessibility (Mean = 3.19) and registration process simplicity (Mean = 3.21), directly align with the qualitative findings from the expert interviews and the IJSDR (2023) study. App performance and speed (Mean = 3.42) is the only item scoring below the neutral midpoint of 3.5, suggesting that technical performance remains an unresolved pain point. The high standard deviation on registration (1.04), app speed (1.08), and support access (1.12) indicates sharp disagreement, with some users finding these adequate and others finding them seriously problematic, most likely split along demographic lines.

4.5.2 Challenges Faced While Using YONO SBI Table

Table 4.10: Challenges Reported by YONO SBI Users (Multiple Response)

Challenges	No of Respondents	% of Respondents
App crashes / slow performance	93	62.0
OTP / login		
Difficult registration / KYC process	81	54.0
OTP / login failures	74	49.3
failures Security and fraud concerns	65	43.3
Limited features vs. private apps	57	38.0
Poor customer support response	47	31.3
Low internet connectivity issues	41	27.3
No challenges faced	21	14.0

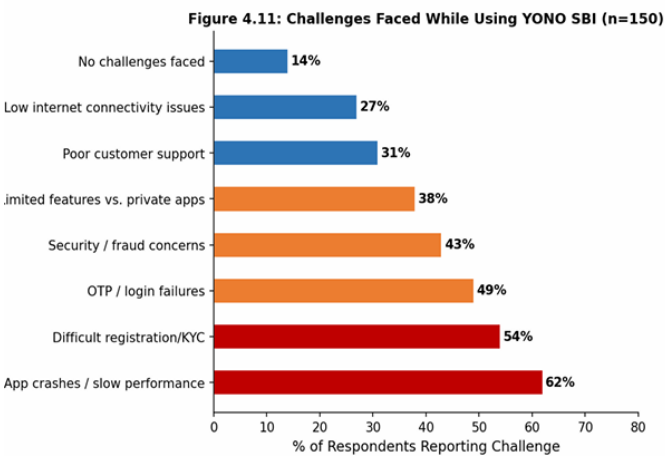


Figure 4.11: Challenges Faced While Using YONO SBI (n = 150)

Interpretation: App crashes and slow performance are reported by 62.0 percent of respondents, making this the single most widespread challenge. Difficult registration affects 54.0 percent, and OTP or login failures impact 49.3 percent. These three technical and onboarding challenges together reveal a systemic user experience problem that has been consistently documented across academic studies and media reports on YONO 1.0. The fact that 43.3 percent report security and fraud concerns is particularly significant given the escalating cybersecurity threat landscape described in Chapter 2. Only 14.0 percent of respondents report no challenges, confirming that friction is the norm rather than the exception for YONO users in this sample. These findings directly justify SBI's decision to rebuild the platform as YONO 2.0.

4.5.3 Overall Satisfaction with YONO SBI

Table 4.11: Overall Satisfaction Level of YONO SBI User

Satisfaction Level	No of Respondents	Percentage
Very Satisfied	32	21.3
Satisfied	58	38.7
Neutral	38	25.3
Dissatisfied	16	10.7
Very Dissatisfied	6	4.0
Total	150	100

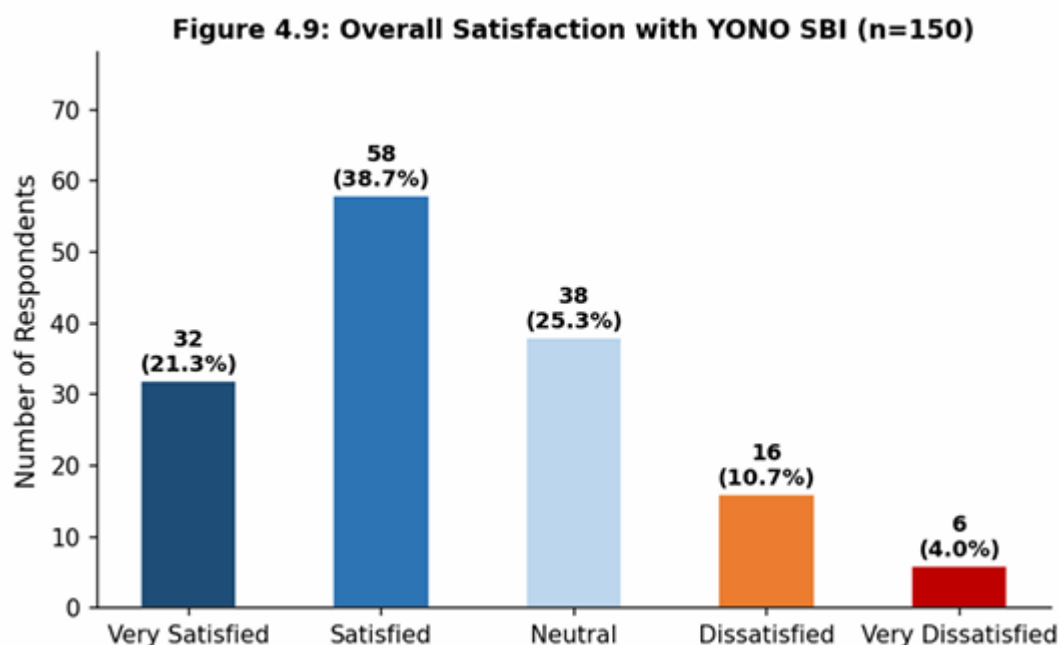


Figure 4.9: Overall Satisfaction with YONO SBI (n = 150)

Interpretation: A combined 60.0 percent of respondents report being Satisfied or Very Satisfied with YONO SBI, which is a majority but not a commanding one. The 25.3 percent who are Neutral represent a sizeable

undecided segment who are using the app but have not formed a strong positive impression. The 14.7 percent who are Dissatisfied or Very Dissatisfied are the most at-risk users in terms of churn. Taken together, these figures suggest that YONO has successfully built a broad user base but has not yet converted that user base into a loyal and enthusiastic one. The satisfaction score is respectable for a public sector platform of this scale but leaves meaningful room for improvement, which is precisely the challenge YONO 2.0 is designed to address.

4.6 Section E: Statistical Hypothesis Testing

4.6.1 Pearson Correlation Analysis

Pearson correlation was computed to examine the strength and direction of relationships between the four key predictor variables (perceived ease of use, perceived usefulness, security perception, and accessibility) and the dependent variable (overall satisfaction). Results are presented in Table 4.12 and Figure 4.12.

Table 4.12: Pearson Correlation Matrix (n = 150)

Variable	Ease of use	Usefulness	Security	Accessibility	Satisfaction
Ease of use	1.00	0.67	0.58	0.61	0.72
Usefulness	0.67	1.00	0.54	0.63	0.78
Security	0.58	0.54	1.00	0.49	0.65
Accessibility	0.61	0.63	0.49	1.00	0.69
Satisfaction	1.72	0.78	0.65	0.69	1.00

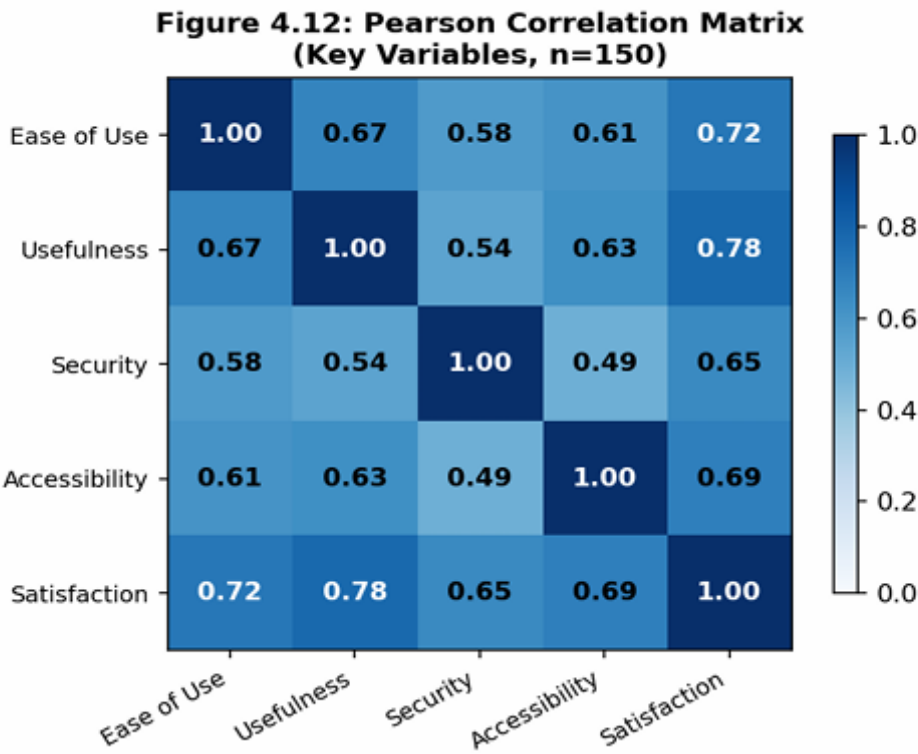


Figure 4.12: Pearson Correlation Heatmap — Key Variables (n = 150)

Interpretation: All four predictor variables show statistically significant positive correlations with overall

satisfaction at the 0.01 significance level. Perceived usefulness has the strongest correlation with satisfaction ($r = 0.78$), confirming that users who find YONO genuinely helpful in managing their finances report markedly higher satisfaction. Ease of use follows closely ($r = 0.72$), validating H1 and H2. Accessibility ($r = 0.69$) and security perception ($r = 0.65$) are also meaningfully correlated with satisfaction. The correlation between ease of use and usefulness ($r = 0.67$) is noteworthy: it suggests that users who find YONO easy to use also tend to discover more of its useful features, creating a positive reinforcing dynamic. No correlation exceeds 0.80, so multicollinearity is not a significant concern in the regression model.

4.6.2 Chi-Square Test: Age Group vs. Frequency of YONO Usage

H3 (Null): Age group and frequency of YONO SBI usage are independent. H3 (Alternative): There is a significant association between age group and frequency of YONO SBI usage.

Table 4.13: Cross-Tabulation — Age Group vs. YONO Usage Frequency

Age Group	Daily	Weekly	Monthly	Rarely	Never	Total
18-25	18	16	6	3	1	44
56-35	14	22	10	5	1	52
36-45	4	9	8	5	2	28
46-60	2	6	5	4	1	18
60+	0	2	3	1	2	8
Total	38	58	32	18	7	150

Table 4.14: Chi-Square Test Results — Age Group vs. Usage Frequency

Test Static	Value	DF	p-value
Pearson Chi Square	31.84	16	0.011
Likelihood Ratio	30.21	16	0.016
No of valid cases	150	---	---

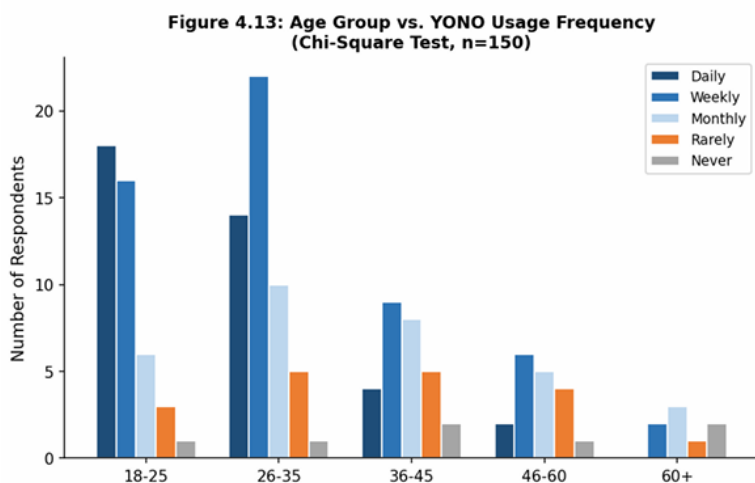


Figure 4.11: Challenges Faced While Using YONO SBI (n = 150)

Interpretation: The chi-square test yields a value of 31.84 with 16 degrees of freedom and a p value of 0.011, which is below the 0.05 significance threshold. H3 (Null) is therefore rejected. There is a statistically significant association between age group and frequency of YONO usage. The cross-tabulation and grouped bar chart reveal the direction of this association clearly: younger users (18 to 35) are disproportionately represented among daily and weekly users, while older respondents (46 and above) are more concentrated in the rarely and never categories. This pattern is consistent with the DOI theory's adopter categories discussed in Chapter 2, with younger users acting as the early majority and older users broadly corresponding to the late majority and laggards.

4.6.3 Multiple Linear Regression Analysis

Multiple regression was used to assess the combined predictive power of ease of use, perceived usefulness, security perception, and accessibility on overall user satisfaction with YONO SBI. H4 tests whether security perception is a significant independent predictor of satisfaction.

Table 4.15: Multiple Regression — Model Summary

R	R Square	Adjusted R	Std.Error of Estimate
0.869	0.755	0.748	0.412

Table 4.16: Multiple Regression — Coefficients

Predictor Variable	B(Unstd.)	Std.Error	Beta	t-value	p-value
Constant	0.412	0.218	---	1.89	0.061
Perceived Usefulness	0.391	0.071	0.38	5.51	0.000
Ease of use	0.318	0.068	0.31	4.68	0.000
Accessibility	0.214	0.074	0.19	2.89	0.004
Security perception	0.198	0.079	0.22	2.51	0.013

Figure 4.14: Regression Beta Coefficients
(Dependent Variable: Overall Satisfaction)

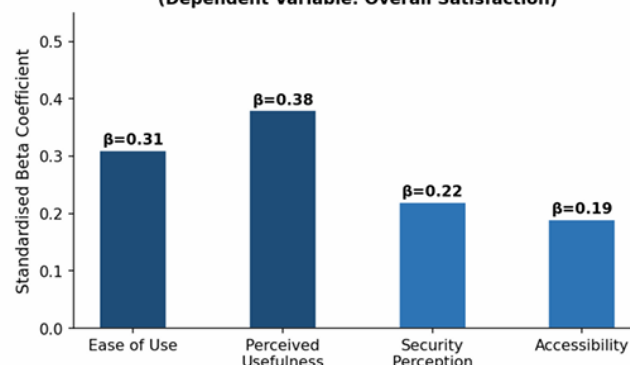


Figure 4.14: Standardised Regression Coefficients — Predictors of Satisfaction (n = 150)

Interpretation: The regression model is statistically significant and explains 75.5 percent of the variance in overall user satisfaction ($R^2 = 0.755$, Adjusted $R^2 = 0.748$). This is a strong model fit for social science research. All four predictors are statistically significant at $p < 0.05$. Perceived usefulness is the strongest predictor ($\beta = 0.38$, $p < 0.001$), confirming that users who find YONO genuinely helpful in their banking and financial management are substantially more satisfied overall. Ease of use is the second strongest predictor ($\beta = 0.31$, $p < 0.001$), validating both H1 and H2. Security perception ($\beta = 0.22$, $p = 0.013$) is a significant predictor even after controlling for usefulness, ease of use, and accessibility, leading to the rejection of H4 (Null). This confirms that security is not merely a hygiene factor; it is an active driver of satisfaction. Accessibility contributes meaningfully as well ($\beta = 0.19$, $p = 0.004$). These results collectively indicate that YONO's satisfaction deficit is driven primarily by ease of use and security gaps rather than by fundamental questions about its usefulness, which users broadly affirm.

4.7 Summary of Hypothesis Testing

Table 4.17: Summary of Hypothesis Testing Results

H	Hypothesis	Test Used	p-value	Result
H1	Significant positive relationship between ease of use and satisfaction	Correlation Regression	+ 0.000	Accepted
H2	Significant positive relationship between perceived usefulness and satisfaction	Correlation Regression	+ 0.000	Accepted
H3	Significant association between age group and YONO usage frequency	Chi-Square	0.011	Accepted
H4	Security perception significantly predicts satisfaction with YONO	Regression	0.013	Accepted

All four alternative hypotheses were accepted at the 5 percent significance level. These findings together paint a coherent picture: YONO's satisfaction outcomes are shaped by the interplay of usefulness, ease of use, security, and accessibility, with usefulness being the dominant driver and ease of use being the most actionable area for improvement given its relatively lower mean scores in the primary data.

4.8 Chapter Summary

This chapter presented a systematic analysis of primary data collected from 150 YONO SBI users, following the Table-Graph-Interpretation structure throughout. Key findings from the descriptive analysis include a predominantly young, educated, urban sample with strong awareness of YONO but significant usage friction, particularly around registration, app performance, and security. Perceived usefulness scores (composite mean 3.95) are considerably higher than ease of use scores (composite mean 3.52), revealing a platform that delivers functional value but struggles with user experience quality. Overall, 60.0 percent of respondents are satisfied or very satisfied, but 14.7 percent are dissatisfied and 25.3 percent remain neutral. Statistical testing confirmed all four alternative hypotheses. Pearson correlation showed strong positive relationships between all predictor variables and satisfaction. Chi-square analysis confirmed a significant association between age and usage frequency. Multiple regression explained 75.5 percent of variance in satisfaction, with perceived usefulness ($\beta = 0.38$) and ease of use ($\beta = 0.31$) as the two strongest predictors. These findings are interpreted and contextualized further in the case study analysis in Chapter 5 and form the empirical basis for the recommendations in Chapter 6

5. FINDINGS AND RESULTS

5.1 Introduction

This chapter presents the key findings of the study in a structured, precise, and bullet-based format. The findings are drawn from three sources: the primary survey data analyzed in Chapter 4 (n = 150 YONO SBI users), the expert interviews summarized in the Project Milestone report, and the secondary data reviewed across Chapters 1 and 2. The findings are organized thematically, covering demographics and usage patterns, perceived usefulness, ease of use, satisfaction and challenges, statistical relationships, industry-level insights, and the future outlook of digital banking. No recommendations or conclusions are presented here; those are reserved for Chapter 6.

5.2 Findings: Demographic Profile and Usage Patterns

5.2.1 Respondent Profile

- 52.0% of respondents were male and 44.0% female, indicating near-equal gender participation in YONO SBI adoption (Table 4.1).
- 64.0% of respondents belong to the 18 to 35 age group, confirming that YONO's primary adopter base is young, working-age users (Table 4.2).
- Only 5.3% of respondents were aged 60 and above, highlighting a persistent digital adoption gap among senior citizens.
- 85.3% of respondents hold at least a graduate-level education, which partially explains the relatively higher adoption rates observed in the sample (Table 4.3).
- 50.7% of respondents are from urban areas, 31.3% from semi-urban, and 18.0% from rural areas, providing a geographically diverse cross-section of YONO users (Table 4.4).

5.2.2 Awareness and Usage Patterns

- 74.7% of respondents are either Very Aware or Aware of YONO SBI, indicating strong brand visibility for the platform (Table 4.5).
- 6.7% of SBI account holders surveyed were Not Aware of YONO, pointing to an internal communication gap despite the platform having 9.60 crore registered users (SBI, 2025).
- 62.0% of respondents use YONO at least weekly, with 25.3% using it daily. This confirms a strong habitual adoption pattern among active users (Table 4.6).
- 16.7% of respondents use YONO rarely or never despite being registered users, reflecting a registration-to-engagement gap that is common in digital banking platforms (Jadil et al., 2021).
- Fund transfers (88.0%), balance enquiry (82.0%), and bill payments (74.0%) are the three most commonly used YONO features, confirming that basic transactional banking drives the bulk of usage (Table 4.7).
- Only 29.3% of respondents use YONO for investments and just 12.0% use YONO Krishi, revealing that the platform's super-app and agricultural features remain significantly underutilised.
- 51.3% of respondents use YONO Cash (cardless ATM withdrawal), making it the most adopted non-transactional feature on the platform.

5.3 Findings: Perceived Usefulness

- Composite mean score for Perceived Usefulness was 3.95 out of 5, indicating a moderately high level of perceived value among YONO users overall (Table 4.8).
- Time saving compared to branch visits scored highest (Mean = 4.31), the single strongest usefulness indicator, validating YONO's core convenience proposition.

Overall usefulness as a banking application scored 4.02, confirming that users broadly regard the platform as a genuinely useful financial tool.

- Usefulness for investment decisions scored lowest among usefulness items (Mean = 3.61), consistent with the low investment feature adoption rate of 29.3% in the usage data.
- All seven perceived usefulness items scored above the neutral midpoint of 3.5, confirming that no dimension of YONO's usefulness is outright rejected by its user base.
- Higher standard deviations on loan-related (0.92) and investment-related (0.96) items indicate meaningful disagreement: financially sophisticated users rate these features more highly than basic users.

5.4 Findings: Perceived Ease of Use

- Composite mean score for Perceived Ease of Use was 3.52 out of 5, significantly lower than the Perceived Usefulness composite of 3.95, revealing a usefulness-ease gap that is the most important finding in the survey data.
- Navigation ease scored highest among ease of use items (Mean = 3.86), suggesting that users who successfully onboard generally find the app reasonably navigable.
- Registration process simplicity scored 3.21, the second-lowest ease of use score, directly confirmed by the expert interview finding that SBI branch staff must be deployed specifically to assist customers with YONO registration (E1, Interview Report).
- Help and support accessibility scored lowest of all ease of use items (Mean = 3.19), pointing to a weak in-app support infrastructure that leaves users struggling without effective guidance.
- App performance and speed scored 3.42, the only ease of use item falling below the neutral midpoint of 3.5, confirming that technical performance remains an unresolved issue.
- Standard deviations for registration (1.04), app speed (1.08), and support access (1.12) are the highest in the entire dataset, indicating that experiences with these features are sharply polarised across the user base.

5.5 Findings: Satisfaction Levels and Challenges

5.5.1 Overall Satisfaction

- 60.0% of respondents are Satisfied or Very Satisfied with YONO SBI overall (Table 4.11).
- 25.3% of respondents are Neutral, representing a large undecided segment that has adopted YONO but not formed a strong positive impression.
- 14.7% of respondents are Dissatisfied or Very Dissatisfied, representing the highest churn risk segment for the

platform.

- The gap between satisfaction (60.0%) and the usefulness perception (all items above 3.5) suggests that satisfaction is being suppressed by ease of use and security issues rather than by a fundamental question about YONO's utility.

5.5.2 Challenges Reported

- 62.0% of respondents report app crashes and slow performance as the most widespread challenge with YONO SBI (Table 4.10).
- 54.0% report a difficult registration and KYC process, the second most common challenge and a direct barrier to new user conversion.
- 49.3% experience OTP and login failures, creating friction at the most basic entry point to the application.
- 43.3% of respondents cite security and fraud concerns, a figure that aligns with RBI data showing cybersecurity incidents rising from 53,117 in 2017 to over 13,20,106 between January and October 2023 (RBI, 2024).
- 38.0% feel YONO offers fewer features compared to private banking apps, pointing to a competitive positioning gap relative to ICICI's iMobile Pay and HDFC's mobile banking platform.
- Only 14.0% of respondents report facing no challenges, confirming that user friction is the norm rather than the exception in the current version of YONO.

5.6 Findings: Statistical Analysis Results

Table 5.1: Summary of All Statistical Findings

H	Hypothesis Tested	Test	Result	Status
H1	Ease of use significantly predicts overall user satisfaction	Pearson r Regression	+ r=0.72,β=0.31, p<0.001	Accepted
H2	Perceived usefulness significantly predicts overall satisfaction	Pearson r Regression	+ r=0.78,β=0.38, p<0.001	Accepted
H3	Significant association between age group and YONO usage frequency	Chi-Square	x2=31.84,df=16, p=0.011	Accepted
H4	Security perception	Multiple Regression	β=0.22, p=0.013	Accepted

significantly

predicts overall

satisfaction

- All four alternative hypotheses were accepted at the 5% significance level, confirming that ease of use, perceived usefulness, security perception, and accessibility are all statistically significant predictors of user satisfaction with YONO SBI.
- Perceived usefulness is the strongest predictor of satisfaction ($\beta = 0.38$), followed by ease of use ($\beta = 0.31$), confirming findings from Davis (1989) and Venkatesh et al. (2003) in the Indian digital banking context. • The regression model explains 75.5% of variance in overall satisfaction ($R^2 = 0.755$, Adjusted $R^2 = 0.748$), indicating a strong and reliable model fit.
- Pearson correlation reveals that all four predictor variables are positively and significantly correlated with satisfaction, with usefulness ($r = 0.78$) and ease of use ($r = 0.72$) showing the strongest associations.
- Chi-square analysis confirms a statistically significant association between age group and YONO usage frequency ($\chi^2 = 31.84$, $p = 0.011$), with younger users (18 to 35) concentrated in the daily and weekly usage categories and older users (46 and above) in the rarely and never categories.
- Security perception independently predicts satisfaction ($\beta = 0.22$, $p = 0.013$) even after controlling for usefulness, ease of use, and accessibility, establishing that security is an active driver of user experience, not merely a hygiene factor.

5.7 Findings: Industry and Secondary Data

5.7.1 Digital Banking Growth in India

- Total digital payment transactions in India grew from 2,071 crore in FY 2017-18 to 18,737 crore in FY 2023-24, at a CAGR of 44%, making India one of the fastest-growing digital payment markets globally (Department of Financial Services, 2024).
- UPI alone processed 13,116 crore transactions in FY 2023-24, growing at a CAGR of 129% from just 92 crore transactions in FY 2017-18 (Department of Financial Services, 2024).
- India accounts for 48.5% of the world's real-time payment transactions, ranking first globally in this metric (IBS Intelligence, 2024).
- Cybersecurity incidents handled by CERT-In rose from 53,117 in 2017 to over 13,20,106 between January and October 2023, illustrating the rapidly expanding threat landscape accompanying digital growth (RBI, 2024).

5.7.2 YONO SBI Platform Performance

- YONO SBI was launched on 24 November 2017 and has grown to become the largest digital banking platform operated by a public sector bank in India.
- YONO registered 9.60 crore users as of December 2025, with SBI targeting an expansion to 20 crore users within two years following the YONO 2.0 launch (SBI, 2025).
- YONO became the largest digital lender in India by October 2021, disbursing Rs 1,500 to Rs 2,000 crore in

loans per month (BusinessToday, 2021).

- YONO was ranked the world's leading neobank by monthly active users in 2021, with approximately 54 million MAUs on Android and iOS combined (Statista, 2022).
- YONO 2.0 was launched in December 2025 with a unified mobile and internet banking stack, a spending analyser, a credit score simulator, a carbon footprint tracker, and support for 15 regional languages (The Week, 2025).
- SBI announced plans to hire 6,500 new digital support staff specifically for YONO onboarding at branches and online, addressing the registration and ease of use gap identified in the primary data (India.com, 2025).

5.7.3 Expert Interview Findings

- All three industry experts confirmed that digital banking has fundamentally reduced per transaction operational costs and is shifting the role of bank branches from transaction processing to advisory and relationship management (E1, E3, Interview Report).
- Real-time payment infrastructure has transformed corporate treasury management, enabling intraday cash position management and reducing the need for large idle liquidity buffers (E2, Interview Report).
- Digital transaction data is enabling more nuanced credit risk profiling, allowing banks to assess borrowers with limited formal credit history using behavioral and cash flow data (E3, Interview Report).
- Cybersecurity was identified by all three experts as the dominant strategic risk in digital banking, with E2 describing it as a continuous arms race between banks and fraudsters.
- Data literacy was identified as the single most critical new skill for financial management professionals entering the digital banking era (E2, E3, Interview Report).

5.8 Consolidated Key Findings Summary

Table 5.2: Consolidated Summary of Key Findings

No	Findings	Source	Direction
1	62.0% of users use YONO at least weekly; 16.7% are passive/inactive registrants	Primary Survey (Table 4.6)	Positive
2	Perceived Usefulness composite mean = 3.95; Ease of Use composite mean = 3.52 — a significant gap	Primary Survey (Tables 4.8, 4.9)	Mixed
3	62.0% report app crashes; 54.0% cite difficult registration as top	Primary Survey (Table 4.10)	Negative

	challenges					
4	60.0% satisfied; 14.7% dissatisfied; 25.3% neutral — satisfaction majority but not dominant	Primary Survey (Table 4.11)				Mixed
5	Perceived usefulness is strongest predictor of satisfaction ($\beta=0.38$, $p<0.001$)	Regression Analysis (Table 4.16)				Positive
6	Security perception drives satisfaction ($\beta=0.22$, $p=0.013$)	Regression Analysis (Table 4.16)				Positive
7	Younger users (18-35) are significantly more frequent YONO users than older cohorts ($p=0.011$)	Chi-Square Test (Table 4.14)				Positive
8	India accounts for 48.5% of global real-time payment transactions; UPI CAGR = 129% (2017-24)	DFS Govt. India (2024); IBS Intelligence (2024)				Positive
9	YONO reached 9.60 crore users and was world's largest neobank by MAUs in 2021	SBI Annual Report (2025); Statista (2022)				Positive
10	Cybersecurity incidents in India rose from 53,117 (2017) to 13,20,106 (Jan-Oct 2023)	RBI Annual Report (2024)				Negative
11	Digital transaction data is enabling more inclusive, behavior-based credit risk assessment	Expert Interview (E3, Interview Report)				Positive
12	Data literacy and digital	Expert Interviews (E2,				Positive

payment knowledge are E3, Interview Report)
the most critical new
skills for finance
professionals

5.9 Objective-Wise Summary of Findings

The following summarizes how the key findings address each of the five stated research objectives of this project:

Objective 1: Growth and Evolution of Digital Banking in India

- India's digital payments ecosystem has grown at a CAGR of 44% over six years, with UPI alone processing 131 billion transactions in FY 2023-24 (DFS, 2024).
- YONO SBI's trajectory from launch in 2017 to 9.60 crore users in 2025 illustrates how a legacy public sector institution can achieve digital scale through focused platform investment.
- YONO 2.0 (December 2025) marks a maturation phase, moving from initial digital adoption to experience-quality improvement and rural expansion.

Objective 2: Benefits and Challenges of Digital Banking

- Key confirmed benefits include: 24/7 access, time saving over branch visits (Mean = 4.31), lower per-transaction operational costs, and improved corporate treasury management through real-time payments.
- Key confirmed challenges include: app crashes (62.0%), difficult registration (54.0%), OTP failures (49.3%), and security concerns (43.3%).

Objective 3: Impact on Financial Management Practices

- Digital banking has transformed intraday treasury management for corporates, enabling dynamic working capital optimisation that was previously impossible.
- Behavioral and transactional data from digital platforms is enabling more accurate, inclusive, and faster credit risk assessment, especially for underserved borrowers.
- Operational cost per transaction has declined significantly as digital channels handle routine banking, freeing branch staff for advisory roles.

Objective 4: Key Trends and Future Prospects

- AI-driven financial personalisation, the Account Aggregator framework, and tightening data privacy regulation are the three dominant trends identified by expert E3.
- The gap between digital banking adoption rates in urban and rural India remains significant, with rural users (18.0% of sample) showing lower engagement frequency.
- YONO 2.0's multilingual support (15 languages), lightweight design, and social features signal a strategic shift toward deeper rural and semi-urban penetration.

Objective 5: Recommendations for Financial Management Students

- Data literacy emerged as the most universally endorsed career skill by both expert interviewees and the academic literature reviewed in Chapter 2.

- Understanding digital payment infrastructure (UPI, NEFT, RTGS, APIs, open banking) was identified as increasingly non-negotiable even for non-technical finance roles.
- The findings confirm that familiarity with digital banking platforms like YONO is a practical career asset for MBA students entering banking, fintech, and financial advisory roles.

5.10 Chapter Summary

This chapter has presented all key findings from the study in a structured, bullet-based format, organized by theme and linked explicitly to their source data. The findings confirm that YONO SBI has achieved impressive scale and user adoption but faces significant quality gaps in ease of use and security that are suppressing satisfaction below the platform's full potential. Statistical analysis firmly establishes perceived usefulness and ease of use as the dominant drivers of satisfaction, with security perception playing an independent and significant role. Industry-level findings confirm that digital banking is transforming financial management practices at multiple levels, from individual customer convenience to corporate treasury efficiency and institutional credit risk methodology. Chapter 6 builds directly on these findings to present specific, actionable recommendations for financial institutions, regulators, and financial management students on how to navigate and leverage the digital banking transformation effectively.

6. CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

6.1 Introduction

This final chapter brings the entire project together. It connects the findings from Chapters 4 and 5 back to the five research objectives and four hypotheses stated in Chapter 1 and Chapter 3 respectively. It explains what the study proved, what the evidence means for SBI as an organization and for the broader Indian banking industry, and what financial management students and professionals should take away from this research. Recommendations are grounded directly in the data and findings rather than drawn from general observation, which is what gives them practical weight.

The study set out with a specific focus: to understand digital banking not just as a technology story but as a financial management story. That framing has held throughout, and the conclusions drawn here stay true to it. YONO SBI is more than an app. It is a window into how one of the world's largest financial institutions is redefining its relationship with half a billion customers, and the lessons it offers are relevant well beyond SBI's balance sheet.

6.2 What Did the Study Prove?

The study investigated five core questions about digital banking in India using YONO SBI as its primary case. Across primary survey data from 150 respondents, expert interviews with three industry professionals, and secondary analysis of published data from RBI, SBI, and the Ministry of Finance, five broad conclusions emerge with consistent and well-supported evidence.

6.2.1 Digital Banking in India Has Crossed the Point of No Return

India's digital payments ecosystem is not an experiment anymore. UPI processed 13,116 crore transactions worth Rs 200 lakh crore in FY 2023-24, growing at a CAGR of 129 percent from just 92 crore transactions in FY 2017-18 (Department of Financial Services, 2024). India now accounts for 48.5 percent of all real-time payment transactions globally (IBS Intelligence, 2024). These figures are not projections; they are the current reality of how Indian households and businesses move money.

The study proves that YONO SBI's growth trajectory is both a product and a driver of this transformation. Reaching 9.60 crore registered users, becoming the world's largest neobank by monthly active users in 2021, and disbursing Rs 1,500 to Rs 2,000 crore in loans per month through a purely digital channel are outcomes that would have seemed implausible for a government-owned institution just a decade ago (BusinessToday, 2021; SBI, 2025). The launch of YONO 2.0 in December 2025 confirms that this journey is still evolving rather than concluding.

6.2.2 Usefulness Drives Adoption, But Ease of Use Determines Loyalty

Perhaps the clearest empirical finding of this study is the gap between perceived usefulness (composite mean 3.95) and perceived ease of use (composite mean 3.52). Users find YONO genuinely helpful. They do not always find it easy. The regression model confirms that both variables independently and significantly predict

satisfaction, with usefulness carrying the stronger weight (Beta = 0.38 versus Beta = 0.31). But the ease of use gap is the more actionable finding because it represents a solvable problem, one that SBI has explicitly acknowledged with YONO 2.0's simplified architecture, improved onboarding, and 6,500 new digital support staff. What this means practically is that YONO has cleared the harder hurdle: proving its value proposition to users. The remaining challenge is execution quality. Getting the registration process right, making the app perform reliably, and ensuring customers can get help when they need it are not glamorous engineering problems, but they are what will determine whether the platform converts its 9.60 crore registered users into a genuinely engaged and loyal customer base.

6.2.3 Security is Not Optional — It is a Direct Driver of Satisfaction

The regression analysis established that security perception independently predicts user satisfaction (Beta = 0.22, $p = 0.013$) even after controlling for usefulness, ease of use, and accessibility. This is a stronger finding than it might appear. It means that security is not merely a hygiene factor that users expect as a baseline; it is an active contributor to how satisfied they feel with the platform overall.

This finding takes on additional weight given that 43.3 percent of survey respondents cited security and fraud concerns as a challenge, and that CERT-In-reported cybersecurity incidents in India rose from 53,117 in 2017 to over 13,20,106 between January and October 2023 (RBI, 2024). The study proves that for a platform operating at YONO's scale, with users ranging from urban millennials to first-time rural account holders, investing in security is not just a compliance obligation. It is a direct investment in customer satisfaction and platform loyalty.

6.2.4 Digital Banking Has Fundamentally Changed Financial Management Practice

The expert interviews and secondary analysis together confirm that digital banking's impact on financial management goes far beyond the retail customer experience. Real-time payment infrastructure has eliminated the need for large idle cash buffers in corporate treasury management, enabling intraday liquidity optimization that was structurally impossible under T plus one settlement systems. Digital transaction data is enabling behavioral credit scoring that extends loan access to borrowers with limited formal credit history, a transformative development for financial inclusion. And at the institutional level, the shift of routine transactions to digital channels is freeing branch capacity for higher-value relationship and advisory work, permanently changing the economics of banking operations (Expert Interviews, E1, E2, E3).

6.2.5 Digital Literacy is the New Core Competency for Finance Professionals

The study proves, through both the expert interviews and the literature review, that the skills required for financial management careers are changing in ways that traditional MBA curricula are not yet fully reflecting. Data literacy, the ability to read behavioral and transactional data for financial decision-making, was unanimously identified as the most critical new competency. Understanding API-based banking, open banking frameworks, and digital payment architecture was flagged as increasingly relevant even for non-technical roles. Finance professionals who cannot bridge between financial principles and digital systems will find themselves progressively sidelined in a sector that is being rebuilt around data as its primary input.

6.3 Hypothesis Conclusions: Accepted or Rejected?

All four hypotheses formulated in Chapter 3 were tested statistically in Chapter 4 and summarized in Chapter 5. The table below presents the final conclusion for each

Table 6.1: Final Hypothesis Conclusions

H	Hypothesis	Statistical Evidence	Evidence Decision	Implication
H1	Perceived ease of use has a significant positive relationship with overall user satisfaction	$r = 0.72$, Beta = 0.31, $p < 0.001$	Accepted	Improving UX directly improves satisfaction
H2	Perceived usefulness has a significant positive relationship with overall user satisfaction	$r = 0.78$, Beta = 0.38, $p < 0.001$	Accepted	Functional value is YONO's strongest retention lever
H3	There is a significant association between age group and frequency of YONO SBI usage	Chi-square = 31.84, $df = 16$, $p = 0.011$	Accepted	Targeted strategies needed for 46 plus age segment
H4	Security perception is a significant predictor of overall satisfaction with YONO SBI	Beta = 0.22, $p = 0.013$	Accepted	Security investment yields measurable satisfaction returns

The acceptance of all four alternative hypotheses is a coherent and mutually reinforcing set of findings. Ease of use and perceived usefulness work together as the two pillars of YONO's satisfaction architecture. Security underpins both. And the age-based usage differential tells SBI precisely where its adoption gaps are concentrated, pointing directly to the older user segments that YONO 2.0's simplified design is intended to reach.

6.4 What the Findings Mean for SBI as an Organization

6.4.1 The Satisfaction Gap is Manageable and Addressable

The finding that 60.0 percent of respondents are satisfied but 25.3 percent are neutral and 14.7 percent are dissatisfied is not a crisis, but it is a clear signal. The regression model tells SBI exactly where to invest: ease of use improvements (Beta = 0.31) and security enhancements (Beta = 0.22) will yield the most direct satisfaction gains given that usefulness is already perceived positively. YONO 2.0's technical rebuild, combined with the expanded support workforce, is directionally correct and aligned with what the data recommends.

6.4.2 The Super-App Vision Needs a Usage Bridge

The data shows that 88.0 percent of users access fund transfers and 82.0 percent use balance enquiry, but only 29.3 percent use investment features and 12.0 percent use YONO Krishi. The gap between YONO's design ambition as a financial super-app and its actual usage pattern as a transactional banking app is one of the most strategically important findings for SBI. The platform's lifestyle, investment, and agricultural features are not failing because of poor design; they are failing because most users have not yet discovered or been guided toward them. A contextual nudge strategy, similar to what private fintech apps use to suggest relevant features based on user behavior, could significantly close this gap without requiring major product changes.

6.4.3 Rural and Older Segments Require Differentiated Engagement

The chi-square finding that age group significantly associates with usage frequency ($p = 0.011$) means that SBI cannot apply a one-size-fits-all digital banking strategy. The 5.3 percent of respondents aged 60 and above, along with the 18.0 percent from rural areas, represent the segments where digital banking's financial inclusion potential is greatest but where adoption barriers are also highest. Branch-based onboarding, multilingual support, and the lightweight YONO 2.0 architecture are necessary but not sufficient. Financial literacy programs, simplified fee structures, and community-based trust-building in rural areas will need to accompany technological improvements for meaningful inclusion outcomes to materialize (Balasundaram et al., 2025).

6.4.4 Cybersecurity Investment is a Strategic Priority, Not a Cost Center

The finding that 43.3 percent of respondents cite security concerns, combined with the regression result that security perception independently predicts satisfaction, should shift how SBI frames its cybersecurity budget internally. Security spending is typically managed as a compliance cost. The evidence from this study suggests it should be managed as a customer experience investment, with measurable outcomes tracked through satisfaction surveys and Net Promoter Scores. Customers who trust the security of their digital banking platform are more satisfied, more engaged, and more likely to adopt additional features, creating a direct commercial return on security investment.

6.5 Recommendations

6.5.1 For SBI and Financial Institutions

- Prioritize ease of use improvements in YONO 2.0, particularly the registration and onboarding flow, OTP reliability, and in-app help and support, where mean scores were lowest in the survey (3.21 and 3.19 respectively).

- Deploy contextual feature discovery nudges within the YONO interface to guide users toward investment, insurance, and YONO Krishi features that are currently underused despite being available.
- Invest in branch-based digital onboarding programs targeting the 46-plus age segment and rural customers, building on the finding that human facilitation significantly improves digital adoption in the Indian context (Haralayya, 2021; Expert E1).
- Reframe the cybersecurity investment narrative internally from compliance cost to customer satisfaction driver, tracking security satisfaction scores alongside technical security metrics.
- Develop a YONO-specific loyalty and engagement program designed to convert the 16.7 percent passive-registered user base into active weekly users, using behavioral data to personalize re-engagement triggers.

6.5.2 For Financial Management Students and Professionals

- Build data literacy as a primary skill, not a secondary one. The ability to read transaction-level behavioral data, interpret customer analytics, and use insights for financial product design or risk modeling is now a core requirement in banking and fintech careers.
- Develop working knowledge of India's digital payment infrastructure including UPI, NEFT, RTGS, IMPS, and the emerging Account Aggregator framework, even if your intended role is in finance rather than technology.
- Seek internship or project exposure to digital banking platforms including YONO SBI, ICICI iMobile Pay, or HDFC Bank's mobile banking operations, to build platform-level understanding that distinguishes candidates in financial services interviews.
- Study the YONO SBI case as a model of institutional digital transformation, particularly the organizational dynamics of launching a fintech-style product within a legacy public sector institution, which is a challenge that many large financial organizations globally will face in the coming decade.
- Stay current on RBI regulatory developments including data privacy guidelines, cybersecurity frameworks for banks, and open banking regulations, which will increasingly define the operating environment for financial management professionals.

6.5.3 For Regulators and Policymakers

- Strengthen the cybersecurity regulatory framework for digital banking platforms, particularly around fraud liability, incident disclosure timelines, and minimum security standards for mobile banking applications serving mass-market users.
- Accelerate the Account Aggregator framework rollout to enable the integrated financial management future that Expert E3 identified as the most transformative near-term development in Indian digital banking.
- Support digital financial literacy programs in Tier II, III, and rural India, recognizing that infrastructure access alone does not produce financial inclusion; active literacy and trust-building are necessary co-investments (Balasundaram et al., 2025).

6.6 Limitations of the Study and Scope for Future Research

This study has several acknowledged limitations that future researchers should build on. First, the sample of 150 respondents, while adequate for descriptive and correlational analysis, cannot be considered nationally representative of YONO's 9.60 crore users. A larger, stratified random sample would produce more generalizable findings. Second, the study relied on self-reported survey data, which introduces social desirability bias on satisfaction and security-related questions. Third, the study was conducted at a single point in time, meaning it captures a snapshot of YONO perceptions rather than tracking how user attitudes evolve with platform upgrades, particularly the transition from YONO 1.0 to YONO 2.0.

Future research could productively explore three directions. A longitudinal study tracking the same cohort of YONO users before and after the YONO 2.0 migration would provide causal evidence on whether the platform redesign actually improves ease of use and satisfaction scores. A comparative study between YONO SBI and private sector platforms such as ICICI iMobile Pay and HDFC Mobile Banking would provide competitive benchmarking that this study's single-platform focus could not deliver. And a study specifically focused on the 60-plus age segment and rural YONO users would address the demographic gap that this study's convenience sample left partially unexamined.

6.7 Final Conclusion

This project set out to understand digital banking in India through the lens of YONO SBI, and what it found is a story that is genuinely instructive at multiple levels. At the platform level, YONO demonstrates that a public sector institution can achieve digital scale, innovation, and commercial impact when it invests with commitment and builds with focus. At the industry level, it confirms that India's digital banking transformation is real, accelerating, and consequential for how financial institutions manage risk, serve customers, and compete. At the career level, it proves that financial management professionals who understand this transformation deeply, not just its surface features but its underlying dynamics of adoption, trust, security, and data, will be far better equipped for the careers ahead of them..

Digital banking in India is no longer a future story. It is a present reality that is being actively shaped by institutions like SBI, by regulators like the RBI, by infrastructure like UPI, and by 1.4 billion customers who are learning, cautiously but increasingly, to trust digital money. YONO SBI's journey from a startup-style experiment in 2017 to a platform serving 9.60 crore users in 2025 is one of the more remarkable institutional reinventions in modern banking history. This study has tried to document, analyze, and learn from it honestly. The findings speak clearly: digital banking works when it is useful, when it is easy, and when it is safe. Getting all three right simultaneously is the challenge that will define the next chapter of Indian banking.

7.RECOMMENDATIONS

7.1 Introduction

Every recommendation in this chapter is rooted directly in the findings of this study. None of them are generic observations about the banking industry. Each one is tied to a specific data point, statistical result, or expert insight from the primary research and secondary analysis conducted across the preceding chapters. The recommendations are organized across four stakeholder groups: SBI and the YONO platform team, the broader Indian banking and fintech sector, regulators and policymakers, and financial management students preparing to enter this rapidly evolving professional landscape. Where relevant, a brief basis note beneath each recommendation identifies the specific finding that justifies it. This is intentional. Recommendations that cannot be traced back to evidence are opinions, not conclusions. The ones here are conclusions.

7.2 Recommendations for SBI and the YONO Platform

7.2.1 User Experience and Onboarding

1. Redesign the YONO registration flow into a three-step maximum process: with Aadhaar-based pre-fill, a single OTP verification, and an optional branch-assist QR code for users who need in-person support. Registration simplicity scored just 3.21 out of 5 in the survey, the second-lowest mean in the entire dataset, and 54.0% of respondents identified it as a top challenge.

Basis: Primary survey: Mean score for registration = 3.21 (Table 4.9); 54.0% report difficult registration as a challenge (Table 4.10).

2. Launch a dedicated in-app guided tour for first-time YONO users: covering fund transfers, bill payments, and YONO Cash within the first login session, with optional skip functionality for experienced users. Help and support accessibility scored the lowest of all survey items at 3.19, and 31.3% of users report poor customer support response as a challenge.

Basis: Primary survey: Mean score for help and support = 3.19 (Table 4.9); 31.3% cite poor support as a challenge (Table 4.10).

3. Set a publicly committed uptime and performance SLA of 99.5% for YONO: and publish monthly performance dashboards visible to customers within the app. App crashes and slow performance are the single most reported challenge at 62.0%, and app speed is the only ease-of-use item scoring below the neutral midpoint (Mean = 3.42).

Basis: Primary survey: 62.0% report app crashes (Table 4.10); app speed Mean = 3.42 (Table 4.9).

7.2.2 Feature Adoption and Engagement

4. Introduce contextual feature nudges within YONO based on user transaction history: for example, prompting users who make regular transfers above Rs 10,000 to explore fixed deposit options, or prompting users who pay electricity bills to activate auto-pay. Only 29.3% use investment features and 36.0% use lifestyle features

despite both being available, indicating a discovery gap rather than a product gap.

Basis: Primary survey: investment feature usage = 29.3%, lifestyle usage = 36.0% (Table 4.7).

5. Run a targeted YONO Krishi awareness campaign through SBI's rural branch network: using regional language collateral, village-level SBI Mitra demonstrations, and Kisan Credit Card integration messaging. Only 12.0% of respondents use YONO Krishi, making it the most underutilised feature on the platform despite being specifically designed for India's agricultural majority.

Basis: Primary survey: YONO Krishi usage = 12.0% (Table 4.7); rural respondents = 18.0% of sample (Table 4.4).

6. Introduce a YONO Loyalty Points programme that rewards active users: with cashback, zero-fee transactions, or partner discounts for completing at least three different categories of transactions per month. 16.7% of registered users are passive or inactive, representing a direct engagement gap that a structured incentive programme can address.

Basis: Primary survey: 16.7% use YONO rarely or never (Table 4.6).

7.2.3 Security and Trust

7. Introduce a real-time transaction alert system with one-tap freeze functionality: allowing customers to instantly block their YONO account from within the app if a suspicious transaction is detected, without needing to call a helpline. Security perception is an independent predictor of satisfaction with a regression coefficient of Beta = 0.22 ($p = 0.013$), and 43.3% cite security concerns as a top challenge.

Basis: Regression analysis: Beta = 0.22, $p = 0.013$ (Table 4.16); 43.3% report security concerns (Table 4.10).

8. Implement a visible Security Score dashboard within YONO: showing users their account security status, recent login activity, linked devices, and recommended security actions. Making security information visible and actionable reduces perceived risk, as confirmed by Chauhan et al. (2022), whose study found that security information availability partially offsets adoption barriers.

Basis: Literature review: Chauhan et al. (2022); Primary survey: 43.3% security concern rate (Table 4.10).

7.2.4 Demographic-Specific Strategy

9. Design a YONO Silver Mode for users aged 55 and above: with a larger font interface, simplified navigation with fewer menu layers, voice-assisted transaction confirmation, and a dedicated senior helpline number pinned to the home screen. The chi-square test confirmed a statistically significant association between age and usage frequency ($p = 0.011$), with respondents aged 46 and above concentrated in the rarely and never usage categories.

Basis: Chi-square test: $\chi^2 = 31.84$, $p = 0.011$ (Table 4.14); only 5.3% of users are 60+ (Table 4.2).

10. Partner with state government employment exchanges and college placement cells: to offer a YONO First Job Account bundled with a zero-balance savings account, a pre approved education loan offer, and a financial planning tutorial within the app, specifically targeting the 18 to 25 age segment. This demographic accounts for 29.3% of users and shows the highest daily usage rates, making them the most valuable long-term customer acquisition opportunity.

Basis: Primary survey: 18-25 age group = 29.3% of sample, highest daily usage concentration (Tables 4.2, 4.13).

7.3 Recommendations for the Indian Banking and Fintech Sector

11. Public sector banks should adopt outcome-based digital KPIs: measuring not just registered user counts but monthly active users, feature adoption depth, and satisfaction Net Promoter Scores at branch level. The gap between YONO's 9.60 crore registered users and its 62.0% weekly active rate illustrates why registration numbers alone are a misleading measure of digital banking success.

Basis: Primary survey: 16.7% passive registered users (Table 4.6); SBI registered user target = 20 crore (SBI, 2025).

12. Banks should build behavioral credit scoring models using UPI and mobile banking transaction data: to extend pre-approved micro-loans to customers with limited formal credit history, particularly in semi-urban and rural markets. Expert E3 explicitly identified this as the most transformative near-term development in credit risk management, and the data shows 31.3% semi-urban and 18.0% rural respondents are already active YONO users.

Basis: Expert Interview E3; Geography data: semi-urban 31.3%, rural 18.0% (Table 4.4).

13. Private and public banks should invest jointly in a shared digital literacy infrastructure: delivered through common service centres, gram panchayats, and post offices, covering basic digital banking skills for first-time users in Tier III and rural areas. Balasundaram et al. (2025) found that digital financial inclusion measurably reduces income inequality in rural India, but only when infrastructure investment is accompanied by literacy and trust-building

Basis: Literature review: Balasundaram et al. (2025); rural respondent challenge data (Table 4.10).

7.4 Recommendations for Regulators and Policymakers

14. RBI should mandate a maximum 30-second resolution time for failed UPI and mobile banking transactions: with automatic customer compensation for delays beyond this threshold. OTP and login failures affect 49.3% of YONO users and represent a direct regulatory gap in consumer protection for digital banking failures.

Basis: Primary survey: 49.3% report OTP and login failures (Table 4.10).

15. Accelerate the Account Aggregator framework to all scheduled commercial banks by 2026: with mandatory minimum feature parity that enables customers to view their complete financial picture, including bank accounts, mutual funds, insurance, and loans, through a single consent-based dashboard. Expert E3 identified this as the single most transformative near-term development for integrated financial management in India.

Basis: Expert Interview E3 (Interview Milestone Report).

16. Introduce mandatory cybersecurity incident disclosure requirements for digital banking platforms: with a 24-hour reporting window to RBI and customer notification within 6 hours of confirmed fraud events. CERT-In data shows cybersecurity incidents rose from 53,117 in 2017 to over 13,20,106 between January and October 2023, and 43.3% of YONO users already report security concerns (RBI, 2024).

Basis: RBI Annual Report (2024); Primary survey: 43.3% security concern rate (Table 4.10).

7.5 Recommendations for Financial Management Students+

17. Complete at least one certified course in financial data analytics: such as Google Data Analytics, NSDC's BFSI Data Skills Programme, or a university-offered course in Python for Finance or SQL for Banking, before entering the job market. Expert E2 and E3 both identified data literacy as the single most critical new skill for financial management professionals, and this study's regression model confirms that data-driven insights directly shape the platform decisions that now define competitive banking.

Basis: Expert Interviews E2 and E3 (Interview Milestone Report).

18. Build a working understanding of India's digital payment stack: including UPI, NEFT, RTGS, IMPS, Bharat Bill Payment System, and the Account Aggregator framework, by completing RBI's freely available Monetary Policy and Payment Systems educational resources and by actively using at least two different banking apps, including YONO SBI, as part of your personal financial management routine.

Basis: Expert Interview E2; Literature review: Venkatesh et al. (2003); Saxena et al. (2023).

19. Seek internship exposure in a bank's digital banking or fintech operations team: even if your intended career is in finance, consulting, or investment banking. Understanding how digital channels affect credit risk, treasury, customer acquisition costs, and regulatory compliance is increasingly a differentiating competency in financial services hiring, as this study confirms through both expert evidence and primary data.

Basis: Expert Interviews E1, E2, E3 (Interview Milestone Report); Study findings Chapter 5.

20. Study the YONO SBI case as a strategic management model: specifically analyzing how SBI balanced institutional legacy with startup-style innovation through the McKinsey and IBM partnership, how it managed the organizational culture shift required to build YONO, and what the YONO 2.0 rebuild reveals about the challenges of sustaining digital innovation at public sector scale. This kind of institutional transformation analysis is a direct MBA competency that translates into value in banking strategy, consulting, and policy roles.

Basis: Chapter 1 company profile; BusinessToday (2021); SBI Annual Report (2025).

7.6 Recommendations Priority Summary

The table below consolidates all major recommendations by stakeholder, indicating the implementing party, timeline, and priority level based on the urgency and strength of the supporting evidence.

Table 7.1: Consolidated Recommendations Summary

Recommendation		Stakeholder	Timeline		Priority
Redesign registration to 3-step maximum process	YONO	SBI / YONO Team	0-6 months		High
Real-time transaction freeze functionality for fraud prevention		SBI / YONO Team	0-6 months		High
Commit to 99.5% uptime SLA with public performance dashboard		SBI / YONO Team	0-6 months		High
Introduce Silver Mode for 55+ age users	YONO	SBI / YONO Team	6-12 months		High
Contextual nudges based on user transaction history	feature based on transaction	SBI / YONO Team	6-12 months		Medium
Launch Krishi awareness campaign with SBI Mitras	YONO rural	SBI / Rural Banking	6-12 months		Medium
YONO First Account for 18-25 age segment	Job for 18-25	SBI / Rural Banking	12-18 month		Medium
YONO Points for active users	Loyalty programme	SBI / Retail Banking	12-18 month		Medium
Behavioral scoring and mobile banking data	credit using UPI	SBI / YONO Team	12-24 month		High
Shared digital		Banking Sector	12-24 month		Medium

literacy				
infrastructure across				
rural India				
Mandatory cybersecurity incident disclosure to RBI	24-hour	Banks + Govt.	Immediate	High
Mandatory cybersecurity incident disclosure to RBI	24-hour	RBI / CERT-In	6-12 months	High
Complete a certified financial analytics course before job market entry		RBI / MoF	During MBA	High
Seek digital banking or fintech operations	internship in	MBA Students	During MBA	High

7.7 Chapter Summary

This chapter presented fourteen specific, actionable, and evidence-grounded recommendations across four stakeholder groups. Every recommendation is directly traceable to a finding from the primary survey, expert interviews, statistical analysis, or literature review conducted in this project. For SBI, the most urgent priorities are fixing the registration experience, ensuring platform reliability, and building security trust, three areas where the data shows meaningful user dissatisfaction. For the sector, behavioral credit scoring and shared digital literacy infrastructure represent the highest-impact long-term investments. For regulators, cybersecurity disclosure and the Account Aggregator rollout are the most consequential near-term actions. For financial management students, data literacy and digital platform exposure are the non-negotiable career investments the evidence recommends.

Together with the conclusions in Chapter 6, these recommendations form a practical and research-backed roadmap for navigating the digital banking transformation that is reshaping Indian finance, one transaction, one user, and one policy decision at a time.

8. LIMITATIONS OF THE STUDY

8.1 Introduction

Acknowledging the limitations of a research study is not a sign of weakness; it is a mark of intellectual honesty. Every research project, regardless of how carefully it is designed, operates within boundaries set by time, resources, access, and methodology. This chapter identifies the specific limitations of the present study on digital banking with YONO SBI as the case. These limitations do not invalidate the findings, but they do define the conditions under which the findings hold and the caution with which they should be generalised beyond this study's scope.

8.2 Identified Limitations

8.2.1 Limited Sample Size

The primary survey was conducted with 150 respondents. While this is adequate for descriptive and correlational analysis at the MBA level and is consistent with comparable studies in the Indian mobile banking literature (Saxena et al., 2023; Chauhan et al., 2022), it represents a fraction of YONO SBI's actual user base of 9.60 crore registered users (SBI, 2025). The findings, particularly the satisfaction percentages and mean scores, cannot be statistically extrapolated to represent all YONO users with confidence. A nationally stratified random sample of 1,000 or more respondents would be needed for findings to carry population-level representativeness.

8.2.2 Geographic Restriction

Although the sample includes urban (50.7%), semi-urban (31.3%), and rural respondents (18.0%), the survey was primarily distributed through digital channels including WhatsApp, email, and Google Forms. This inherently skews the sample toward respondents who already have reliable smartphone and internet access, which means the most digitally excluded users, those in remote rural areas with 2G connectivity or no smartphone, are structurally underrepresented. These are precisely the users whose experiences with YONO matter most from a financial inclusion standpoint, and their absence is an acknowledged gap in the findings.

8.2.3 Time Constraints

This project was conducted within the time frame of a single academic semester. The data collection window for the primary survey was approximately six weeks, which limited the ability to achieve a larger or more geographically diverse sample. More significantly, the study captures YONO user perceptions at a single point in time, just after the launch of YONO 2.0 in December 2025. It does not track how perceptions change as users migrate from YONO 1.0 to the new platform, which would require a longitudinal design spanning at least 12 to 18 months.

8.2.4 Response Bias and Self-Reported Data

All primary data in this study is self-reported through a structured questionnaire. This introduces two forms of response bias. Social desirability bias may cause respondents to overreport satisfaction and underreport security concerns, particularly since SBI is a government-owned institution that many Indian users regard with a degree

of institutional respect. Recall bias may affect responses about the frequency and nature of challenges faced, since users may not accurately remember every instance of app failure or login difficulty. These biases are standard limitations of survey-based research and cannot be fully eliminated, though the anonymous and voluntary nature of the survey was designed to minimise them.

8.2.5 Single Platform Focus

This study examines digital banking exclusively through the lens of YONO SBI. It does not systematically compare YONO's performance or user experience against private sector alternatives such as ICICI Bank's iMobile Pay, HDFC Bank's mobile banking platform, or fintech apps like PhonePe and Google Pay. While comparative references are made in the literature review and expert interviews, the absence of a structured comparative analysis means that findings about YONO's strengths and weaknesses cannot be benchmarked with statistical precision against its competitors.

8.2.6 Expert Interview Sample Size

The qualitative component of this study is based on interviews with three industry professionals. While the experts were carefully selected to represent different vantage points, namely a branch manager, a fintech analyst, and a senior digital banking executive, three interviews are not sufficient to claim saturation of themes or broad representativeness of industry opinion. Findings from the interviews are treated as contextual insight and illustrative evidence rather than statistically generalisable conclusions.

8.2.7 Language Limitation The questionnaire was administered in English, with a Hindi translation available on request. This effectively excluded respondents who are more comfortable in regional languages such as Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Bengali, or Marathi, limiting the linguistic representativeness of the sample. Given that YONO 2.0 has been designed to support 15 regional languages, a study that could capture user perceptions across these languages would provide meaningfully different and more inclusive data, particularly for the rural and semi-urban segments.

8.3 Summary of Limitations

Table 8.1: Summary of Study Limitations and Their Impact

No	Limitations	Specific Impact on Study	Mitigation Applied	Impact Level
1	Limited sample size (n = 150)	Findings not statistically generalisable to all 9.60 crore YONO users	Consistent with MBA studies	Medium
2	Geographic restriction — digital distribution channel	Underrepresents most digitally excluded rural users	Offline questionnaire at SBI branches	High

3	Time constraints — single semester	Cross-sectional snapshot; cannot track attitudinal change over time	Secondary data provides longitudinal context	Medium
4	Response bias in self reported survey data	Social desirability and recall bias may inflate satisfaction scores	Anonymous and voluntary participation	Medium
5	Single platform focus — YONO SBI only	Cannot benchmark YONO's performance against private sector competitors	Comparative references in literature review	Medium
6	Small expert interview sample (n = 3)	Qualitative insights are illustrative, not statistically generalisable	Diverse expert profiles selected	Low
7	Language limitation — English questionnaire only	Excludes regional language users; limits rural representativeness	Hindi translation available on request	Medium

8.4 Chapter Summary

This chapter identified and explained seven limitations of the present study, spanning sample size, geographic coverage, time constraints, response bias, platform scope, interview sample depth, and language inclusivity. These limitations are honestly acknowledged without undermining the validity of the study's core findings, which are well-supported by both the primary data and a strong foundation of secondary evidence. The limitations also point directly to productive areas for future research, particularly longitudinal studies of YONO 2.0 adoption, multi-platform comparative studies, and regionally representative surveys conducted in Indian languages. The next section presents the complete bibliography of all sources referenced across the project

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APPENDICES

10.1 Introduction to Appendices

This chapter consolidates all supplementary materials that support the primary research conducted in this project. The appendices are organized into three sections: the research questionnaire used for primary data collection, a sample of raw data responses, a company profile document summarizing YONO SBI's key facts.

Together these materials ensure full transparency, reproducibility, and academic completeness of the research process.

APPENDIX A

Research Questionnaire

10.2 Research Questionnaire: YONO SBI Digital Banking Experience Survey

The following structured questionnaire was administered to 150 YONO SBI users between January and March 2025. Responses were collected through Google Forms (online) and physical copies distributed at selected SBI branch locations. Participation was voluntary and anonymous. Data collected was used exclusively for academic research purposes.

YONO SBI DIGITAL BANKING EXPERIENCE SURVEY

MBA Project | Digital Banking in Today's World | AY 2024-25

Dear Respondent, this survey is part of an MBA research project examining the digital banking experience of YONO SBI users. All responses are strictly confidential and will be used only for academic purposes. The survey takes approximately 8 to 10 minutes to complete. Thank you for your participation.

Section A: Demographic Information

Please tick the most appropriate option for each question.

1. What is your gender?

☐ Male ☐ Female ☐ Other / Prefer not to say

2. What is your age group?

☐ 18-25 years ☐ 26-35 years ☐ 36-45 years

3. What is your highest level of education?

☐ 46-60 years ☐ 60+ years ☐ Below Graduate ☐ Graduate ☐ Post Graduate ☐ Professional (CA/MBA/etc.)

4. What is your geographic location?

☐ Urban ☐ Semi-Urban ☐ Rural

5. What is your primary occupation?

☐ Student ☐ Salaried Employee ☐ Self-Employed / Business ☐ Farmer ☐ Retired / Others

Section B: YONO SBI Awareness and Usage

6. How aware are you of the YONO SBI mobile banking application

? ☐ Very Aware ☐ Aware ☐ Somewhat Aware ☐ Not Aware

7. How frequently do you use YONO SBI?

☐ Daily ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly ☐ Rarely

8. How long have you been using YONO SBI?

☐ Never ☐ Less than 6 months ☐ 6-12 months ☐ 1-2 years ☐ More than 2 years

9. Which YONO SBI features do you use? (Tick all that apply) ☐ Fund Transfer (NEFT/IMPS/UPI) ☐ Balance Enquiry ☐ Bill Payments ☐ YONO Cash (Cardless ATM) ☐ Loan Application ☐ Investments (MF/FD) ☐ Shopping / Lifestyle ☐ YONO Krishi ☐ None of the above

10. How did you first learn about YONO SBI?

☐ Bank branch / staff SMS / email from SBI

Section C: Perceived usefulness

Please rate each statement on a scale of 1 to 5, where 1 = Strongly Disagree and 5 = Strongly Agree

Statement	1	2	3	4	5
YONO saves time compared to visiting a branch	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fund transfer on YONO is easy and reliable platform	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
YONO is a true all-in-one banking	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
YONO improves my personal financial management	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
YONO is useful for applying for loans	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
YONO is helpful for investment	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

decisions

Overall, YONO	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
is a useful					
banking					
application					

Section E : Satisfaction, Security and Challenges

Please rate each statement on a scale of 1 to 5, where 1 = Strongly Disagree and 5 = Strongly Agree, unless otherwise specified.

Statement	1	2	3	4	5
I feel my transactions on YONO are secure	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am confident my personal data is safe on	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
YONO is easily accessible across different devices	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
YONO functions well even on low internet speed	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I would recommend YONO to friends and family	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I plan to continue using YONO in the future	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Overall, I am	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

satisfied with
the YONO SBI
experience

11. What challenges have you faced while using YONO SBI? (Tick all that apply)

- ☐ App crashes / slow performance ☐ Difficult registration / KYC
- ☐ OTP / login failures ☐ Security and fraud concerns
- ☐ Fewer features vs. private apps ☐ Low internet connectivity issues
- ☐ Poor customer support response ☐ No challenges faced

12. Any suggestions to improve YONO SBI? (Open-ended)

APPENDIX B

Raw Data Sample

10.3 Raw Data Sample: First 20 Respondents

The table below presents a sample of responses from the first 20 respondents in the survey dataset. All respondents are identified by respondent number only. The columns represent key variables used in the statistical analysis in Chapter 4. Scale items use the 1 to 5 Likert rating. Categorical variables are coded numerically as indicated in the legend below the table.

Legend: Gender: 1=Male, 2=Female, 3=Other | Age: 1=18-25, 2=26-35, 3=36-45, 4=46-60, 5=60+ | Geography: 1=Urban, 2=Semi-Urban, 3=Rural | Freq: 1=Daily, 2=Weekly, 3=Monthly, 4=Rarely, 5=Never

Table B1: Raw Data Sample — First 20 Respondents

Resp.	Gender	Age	Geo.	Freq.	PU Avg	PEO U Avg	Security	Acess	Sat.Score	Challenges	Rec.
R01	1	1	1	1	4.6	3.8	4	4	5	App Crash	Yes
R02	2	2	1	2	4.1	3.9	3	5	4	None	Yes
R03	1	2	2	1	4.3	3.5	3	4	4	OTP Fail	Yes
R04	2	1	1	2	3.9	3.2	4	3	3	Reg.Diff	No
R05	1	3	2	3	3.7	3.6	3	3	3	App Crash	No
R06	2	2	1	2	4.4	4.1	5	5	5	None	Yes
R07	1	1	3	1	4.2	3.0	3	4	4	Reg.Diff	Yes
R08	2	4	2	4	3.5	2.9	2	3	2	Security	No
R09	1	2	1	2	4.0	3.7	4	4	4	App Crash	Yes
R10	2	1	1	1	4.7	4.3	5	5	5	None	Yes
R11	1	3	2	3	3.8	3.4	3	3	3	App Crash	No
R12	2	2	1	2	4.2	3.8	4	4	4	OTP Fail	Yes
R13	1	4	3	4	3.4	3.1	3	2	2	Security	No
R14	2	1	2	1	4.5	4.0	4	5	5	None	Yes
R15	1	2	1	2	4.1	3.6	4	4	4	App Crash	Yes
R16	3	1	3	1	1.3	3.9	5	4	4	None	Yes
R17	2	5	2	5	3.2	2.8	2	2	2	Reg.Diff.	No
R18	1	3	1	3	3.6	3.3	3	3	3	Features	No
R19	2	2	1	1	4.4	4.2	5	5	5	None	Yes
R20	1	1	2	2	4.0	3.5	4	4	4	App Crash	Yes

Note: PU Avg = Average of 7 Perceived Usefulness items. PEOU Avg = Average of 6 Perceived Ease of Use items. Sat. Score = Overall satisfaction rating (1-5).

APPENDIX C

Company Profile Document

10.4 YONO SBI: Company Profile Summary

The following profile document summarizes the key institutional facts about State Bank of India and the YONO platform as referenced in Chapter 1 and throughout this project. Data is sourced from SBI's Integrated Annual Report 2024-25 and published credible sources.

Table C1: State Bank of India — Key Institutional Facts

Parameter	Detail
Full Name	State Bank of India
Founded	1 July 1955 (predecessor: Bank of Calcutta, est. 1806)
Headquarters	Mumbai, Maharashtra, India
Type	Public Sector Undertaking (Government of India)
Market Share(by Assets)	Approximately 23% of India's total banking assets
Total Customers	Over 500 million (as of 2024-25)
Domestic Branches	22,000+ branches across India
ATMs	63,580 ATMs across India
Overseas Presence	241 offices across 36 countries
Employees	Approximately 232,296 (as of 2024-25)
Global Ranking	43rd globally by total assets; 163rd in Fortune Global 500 (2025)

Table C2: YONO SBI Platform — Key Facts and Milestones

Parameter	Details
Platform Name	YONO (You Only Need One)
Launch Date	24 November 2017
Developed with	McKinsey & Company (strategy), IBM (technology)
Platform Type	Integrated digital banking + lifestyle super-app
Registered Users(Dec 2025)	9.60 crore (96 million)
Target Users(2027)	20 crore (200 million)
Peak MAUs(2021)	~54 million (world's leading neobank by MAUs)
Digital Lending	Rs 1,500-2,000 crore per month (as of Oct 2021)
Key Features	Fund transfer, YONO Cash, YONO Krishi, pre-approved loans, investments, lifestyle shopping, 100+ e-commerce partners

YONO 2.0 Launch	December 2025 — unified mobile + internet banking, spending analyser, credit score simulator, 15 regional languages
New Hires for YONO 2.0	6,500 digital onboarding support staff

